

# A Minimal-Parameter Framework for Cosmological Dynamics and Galaxy Cluster Mass Discrepancies via Structural Self-Energy Expansion (SSEE)

Mike Edison Almeida Vallejo

*Independent Researcher*

[mike.almeida1721@gmail.com](mailto:mike.almeida1721@gmail.com)

ORCID: [0009-0008-2195-7836](https://orcid.org/0009-0008-2195-7836)

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## Abstract

We introduce the Structural Self-Energy Expansion (SSEE), a purely algebraic framework that proposes a connection between cosmological expansion and galaxy-cluster dynamics using only two dimensionless geometric constants —  $\pi$  and the golden ratio  $\varphi$  — with a minimal effective parameter count and no WIMP, QCD-axion, or SUSY dark-matter particles. The background sector ( $w_0, w_a, \Omega_{\text{DE}}, \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$ ) is fully algebraic (zero fitted dimensionless parameters); phenomenological extensions in the dark-matter sector (Paper 6) introduce a small set of quantities currently treated as ansätze and tracked as open problems (OP-9, OP-10, OP-11 and OP-12 in `OPEN_PROBLEMS.md`). From these two axioms, a closed set of seven structural registers is derived algebraically, culminating in the dark-energy equation of state

$$w_0 = -\frac{T_r}{M_v} = -\frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} \approx -0.840, \quad w_a = -\frac{P}{I_g} = -\frac{2\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} \approx -0.670.$$

Both reduced forms carry the same denominator  $2(\varphi + \pi) = 9.519253$ , but they descend from *distinct registers*:  $w_0$  from  $M_v = \varphi + \pi + K_v = 14.278880$  and  $w_a$  from  $I_g = \pi + P = 9.519253$ . It is the lineage, not the reduced form, that fixes each ratio. No fitting procedure is involved:  $w_0$  and  $w_a$  are uniquely fixed by the geometry of  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ . The asymptotic structural viscosity factor  $\text{KAL}_0 = \beta + \pi \approx 5.5214$  fixes the cold dark matter density via the forward identity  $\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s$ , reproducing the observed cosmic dark-to-baryonic matter density ratio. These foundational parameters are tested against data in subsequent papers: a full Bayesian MCMC validation against DESI DR2 [Abdul-Karim et al., 2025], Planck 2018 [Planck Collaboration VI, 2020], and galaxy-cluster mass data ( $\Delta\text{BIC} = -6.43$  for the dynamic sector relative to  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ ) is presented in the companion Paper 2 [Almeida Vallejo, 2026], while CMB perturbations and phenomenological extensions are explored in Papers 3–10. The framework is falsifiable: a B-mode polarisation tensor-to-scalar ratio  $r = \varphi^{-10} = 0.008131$  is predicted for LiteBIRD [LiteBIRD Collaboration, 2023] ( $\sim 2032$ ).

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# 1 Introduction and Theoretical Foundations

The observed cosmic acceleration [Perlmutter et al., 1999, Riess et al., 1998] requires an explanation beyond the cosmological constant [Weinberg, 1989], motivating a broad landscape of dynamical dark energy proposals [Ratra & Peebles, 1988, Copeland et al., 2006, Weinberg et al., 2013, Clifton et al., 2012]. The SSEE framework operates under the principle of algebraic closure and macroscopic structural self-energy. Rather than adding particle degrees of freedom, the system’s identity is defined by a closed set of geometric invariants derived exclusively from  $\pi$  and  $\varphi$ . These fundamental scales dictate the macroscopic behaviour of spacetime:

- $\Omega = \pi + \varphi \approx 4.7596$ : Stability Metric.
- $\beta = (\pi + \varphi)/2 \approx 2.3798$ : Base Coupling Scalar.
- $\mathbf{KAL}_0 = \beta + \pi \approx 5.5214$ : Asymptotic Structural Viscosity.
- $P = \Omega + \varphi \approx 6.3777$ : Dynamical Evolution Scalar.
- $K_v = \varphi + \pi + \Omega \approx 9.5193$ : Structural Constraint Invariant.
- $T_r = 3(\varphi + \beta) \approx 11.9935$ : 3D Saturation Horizon.
- $M_v = \varphi + \pi + K_v \approx 14.2789$ : Maximal Dimensional Invariant.

Throughout this work  $=$  separates a register from its *exact* definition, while  $\approx$  introduces only a truncated decimal:  $\Omega$  is  $\pi + \varphi$  with no approximation involved, and it is the four-digit 4.7596 that is approximate, the irrational value having no last digit.

These seven are the structural registers proper. One further register is needed below and is introduced here so that no symbol appears before its definition:  $I_g = \pi + P \approx 9.5193$  (exactly  $\pi + P$ ; the decimal is truncated), the *saturation partner* of the dynamical scalar  $P$ , which is the denominator of  $w_a$ . It carries the same *value* as  $K_v$  (9.519253) while descending from a different construction, and the two are not interchangeable —  $K_v$  is a constraint invariant,  $I_g$  a saturation partner. Sharing a value is not being the same object, and throughout this work the lineage, not the number, identifies a register (Appendix B).

## 1.1 Predictive Register

A common objection to algebraic models is selection bias: that the constant combinations are chosen post-hoc to reproduce known values. The defence against this is *structural*, not chronological: the constants are drawn from a closed dictionary fixed by construction—no optimisation over formula space is performed. A look-elsewhere scan over the *complete* closed dictionary of named  $(\varphi, \pi)$  constants yields 490 distinct ratios in  $(0, 5]$ . Each background equation-of-state value is then searched for with a *deliberately generous* tolerance of  $\pm 0.0005$  — and exactly *one* of the 490 ratios falls inside it, which moreover matches to machine precision ( $|d| < 10^{-16}$ ). The tolerance is generous and the hit is exact: that is the 1-in-490 specificity, and it persists when the full dictionary, not a hand-picked subset, is scanned (reproducible via `look_elsewhere_full.py`). Table 1 classifies each derivation by epistemic status. We make no claim of temporal priority over public datasets: the quantities compared with DESI DR2 and Planck are postdictions or retrodictions; only those tested against not-yet-released data ( $k_{fs}$ ,  $r$ , and the pre-registered DESI DR3

test of the fixed  $(w_0, w_a)$  point) are genuine predictions. The DR3 entry is a genuine timestamped commitment: the point cannot move, so every tightening of the data is a test it must survive without adjustment. Between DR1 and DR2 the  $(w_0, w_a)$  constraint tightened appreciably—from  $w_0 = -0.827 \pm 0.063$ ,  $w_a = -0.75^{+0.29}_{-0.25}$  [Adame et al., 2024] to  $w_0 = -0.838 \pm 0.055$ ,  $w_a = -0.617 \pm 0.208$  [Abdul-Karim et al., 2025], a reduction of  $\sim 33\%$  in the area of the 68% contour (comparing  $\sigma_{w_0} \times \sigma_{w_a}$  with the mean of the asymmetric DR1 error on  $w_a$ :  $0.063 \times 0.27 \rightarrow 0.055 \times 0.208$ )—and the fixed point stayed inside it, moving from  $0.05\sigma$  against DR1 to  $0.24\sigma$  against the tighter DR2 (Pantheon+-class). Because the point is immobile, the tension scales as the inverse of the error bar, so the pre-registered arithmetic is explicit: a further tightening comparable to the DR1→DR2 step leaves us near  $0.4\text{--}0.5\sigma$ , while a joint  $>3\sigma$  exclusion refutes the algebraic background outright. DR3 (expected 2027) will settle it.

Table 1: Predictive Register: SSEE derivations by epistemic status. “Postdiction”: algebraic result fixed by the closed dictionary, then compared to data already public—no claim of temporal priority. “Prediction”: fixed now, tested against not-yet-released data. “Retrodiction”: derived independently, then compared to an existing measurement. No optimisation over the algebraic formula space was performed.

| Quantity (algebraic formula)                                                    | Value                                       | Test / Falsifier                                                           | Status                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <i>Background sector (algebraic dictionary)</i>                                 |                                             |                                                                            |                                    |
| $w_0 = -T_r/M_c$                                                                | $-0.839950$                                 | DESI DR2 (2025)                                                            | Postdiction                        |
| $w_a = -(\Omega + \varphi)/I_g$                                                 | $-0.669975$                                 | DESI DR2 (2025)                                                            | Postdiction                        |
| $(w_0, w_a)$ vs DESI DR3                                                        | same fixed point                            | DR3 $w_0 w_a$ CDM (2027); $>3\sigma$ joint excl. falsifies                 | <b>Prediction (pre-registered)</b> |
| $\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s$                                          | $0.119514$                                  | Planck 2018                                                                | Retrodiction                       |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2$                                          | $0.308881$                                  | Planck 2018                                                                | Retrodiction                       |
| $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$                                                        | $0.965558$                                  | Planck 2018                                                                | Retrodiction                       |
| $H_0 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$                                                      | $67.962 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ | Planck 2018                                                                | Global background anchor (Post. D) |
| <i>Paper 5 — IS causal perturbation theory</i>                                  |                                             |                                                                            |                                    |
| $\gamma_{\text{IS}}$                                                            | $0.550$                                     | RSD surveys ( $\gamma_{\text{ACDM}} = 0.55$ )                              | Retrodiction                       |
| $f\sigma_8(z=0.5)$                                                              | $0.70\sigma$ mean tension                   | 6 RSD surveys, single-sector (BOSS/eBOSS/6dFGS)                            | Retrodiction                       |
| <i>Paper 6 — <math>\varphi</math>-Dark Matter, two-sector</i>                   |                                             |                                                                            |                                    |
| $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} (\text{SOLAR}^2 \cdot \text{KRYSTOS}_V)$ | $40.70 \text{ eV}$                          | Matter $P(k)$ via $k_{\text{fs}}$ (no SM portal)                           | Prediction                         |
| $k_{\text{fs}}$ (Dodelson-Widrow from $m_\phi$ )                                | $0.754 h \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$                  | DESIY3 / Euclid $P(k)$ , 2026–2028                                         | Prediction                         |
| $S_8^{\text{eff}} = \sigma_8 \sqrt{\Omega_m/0.3}$ (two-sector, forward CLASS)   | $0.758$                                     | KiDS-1000 $S_8 = 0.759 \pm 0.024$ ( $0.04\sigma$ )                         | Retrodiction                       |
| <i>Paper 7 — Canonical EFT, Bellini-Sawicki <math>\alpha</math>-functions</i>   |                                             |                                                                            |                                    |
| $\alpha_T = \alpha_M = \alpha_B = 0$ (minimal coupling)                         | 0 exact                                     | GW170817 $ \alpha_T  < 10^{-15}$                                           | Retrodiction                       |
| $\alpha_K^{\text{field}} = 3\Omega_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_\phi)$                     | $0.072567$                                  | Euclid weak lensing 2026–2028; forecast $\sigma(\alpha_{K,0}) \approx 0.1$ | Prediction (below sensitivity)     |
| $\beta_c = -\text{AURA} = -(3\varphi + \pi)/2$                                  | $-3.997847$                                 | EFT plateau test (8 ICs, $\Delta = 0.2\%$ )                                | Retrodiction                       |
| <i>Future</i>                                                                   |                                             |                                                                            |                                    |
| $r = \varphi^{-10}$                                                             | $0.008131$                                  | LiteBIRD $\sim 2032$                                                       | Prediction                         |

“Retrodiction” denotes results derived independently and then compared against previously published values; no optimisation over the algebraic formula space was performed to match a target value. The distinction between postdictions, retrodictions, and genuine predictions is explicitly noted to maintain transparency. All entries with “Prediction” status are falsifiable by named experiments within the stated time horizon. Where the forecast sensitivity already resolves the predicted value, a measurement excluding it at high significance refutes the framework; where it does not—as for  $\alpha_K^{\text{field}}$ , whose forecast error bar exceeds the prediction—the entry is marked *below sensitivity* and a non-detection carries no evidential weight either way.

*Note on the two  $\alpha_K$  values.* Two physically distinct kineticities appear across the suite and must not be conflated: the *bare-field* value  $\alpha_K^{\text{field}} = 3\Omega_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_\phi) = 0.072567$  tabulated above (with  $w_\phi \approx -0.971$  the bare scalar equation of state; this is the quantity Euclid weak lensing will constrain, though its forecast error bar  $\sigma(\alpha_{K,0}) \approx 0.1$  still exceeds the predicted value, so the entry is recorded as *below sensitivity* rather than as a falsifier), versus the *effective background* value  $\alpha_K^{\text{eff}} = 3\Omega_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_0) = 0.403302$  (with  $w_0 = -0.839950$ ) used for the hi.class/EFTCMB cross-check in Table 2. Both are derived; see Paper 7 for the

full  $\alpha_K(a)$  derivation distinguishing them.

## 1.2 Axiomatic Principles

SSEE is explicitly constructed as a top-down theoretical ansatz. Its internal symmetries are not phenomenological fits derived bottom-up, but fundamental axiomatic identities that the macroscopic universe is proposed to satisfy. Three physical principles govern the interactions of these geometric invariants:

1. **The Temporal Triad (Cosmological Epochs):** Spacetime evolves through three distinct thermodynamic states — the Origin/Law phase (initial singularity), the Ignition/Processing phase (structure formation), and the Transcendental Saturation phase (dark energy asymptotic domination). The Hubble history  $H(a)$  is bounded by:

$$\lim_{a \rightarrow 0} H^2(a) \propto \rho_{\text{bar}}, \quad \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} H^2(a) = \frac{8\pi G}{3} \rho_{\text{crit},0} \left( \frac{T_r}{M_v} \right). \quad (1)$$

2. **Non-Self-Addition (Evolution by Difference):** Structural evolution proceeds through non-linear geometric scaling rather than linear superposition. All macroscopic observables  $\mathcal{O}$  must be strictly functional dependencies of the invariant set and  $H_0$ ; no additional free parameters are permitted:

$$\mathcal{O} = f(\Omega, \beta, \text{KAL}_0, P, K_v, T_r, M_v; H_0). \quad (2)$$

3. **Asymmetric Equivalence:** Energy states can possess identical geometric values but divergent dynamic functions. The macroscopic geometric response must inversely mirror the physical source:

$$\mu_{\text{SSEE}}(x) \cdot \text{KAL}(x) \equiv 1. \quad (3)$$

These three statements fix the framework's *physical* content. They are not, by themselves, the assumption budget: §1.3 recasts what SSEE takes as given versus what it derives in terms of three register-level postulates (D, S, I), after the 2026  $\omega_m$ -direct reframe dissolved the former matter-factor postulate M (OP-8 closed). That postulate accounting — not the count of physical statements above — is the authoritative measure of the model's free choices; Principle 1 above supplies the de Sitter endpoint invoked there by Postulate S.

## 1.3 Scope of the Zero-Parameter Claim

The invariant set  $\{\Omega, \beta, \text{KAL}_0, P, K_v, T_r, M_v\}$  and its generators  $\varphi, \pi$  are all *dimensionless*. What the framework derives and what it takes as input is made precise by **three postulates in total**, stated here as pre-registered axioms rather than left implicit: **two foundational** — D (dimensional anchor) and S (saturation correspondence), given immediately below — plus **one auxiliary** register-level postulate, I (inflationary register), given after them. A fourth, the former matter-factor postulate M, is *retired*; it is listed alongside I only to record what it was and why it no longer counts. This is the full assumption budget, and it is recapitulated at the end of the section.

**Postulate D (Dimensional Anchor).** Because the invariant set is dimensionless, SSEE predicts only *dimensionless* quantities: equation-of-state parameters ( $w_0, w_a$ ), density fractions ( $\Omega_{\text{DE}}, \Omega_m$ ), the EFT functions ( $\alpha_K, \alpha_B, \alpha_M, \alpha_T$ ), the spectral observables ( $n_s, r$ ), and the structural ratios (MIRA, etc.). These are unit-independent and directly falsifiable. Any *dimensionful* quantity —  $H_0$ ,  $\rho_{\text{crit}}$ , particle masses — requires exactly *one* dimensional input, the anchor, for which we take  $H_0$ . This is the identical status  $H_0$  holds in  $\Lambda$ CDM, where it is one free parameter. The “zero free parameters” claim therefore means precisely: *zero dimensionless fitted parameters*. SSEE carries one dimensional input ( $H_0$ ) and zero dimensionless ones;  $\Lambda$ CDM carries one dimensional input ( $H_0$ ) and five dimensionless ones ( $\Omega_m, \Omega_b, n_s, A_s, \tau$ ). The algebraic combination  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 \approx 67.96$  supplies  $H_0$  in  $\text{km s}^{-1} \text{Mpc}^{-1}$  and serves as the single *dimensional anchor* of Postulate D (§D): the *dimensionless* value is fixed algebraically, while the *absolute* scale is not claimed to be derived from a fundamental energy. Deriving the absolute scale of  $H_0$  from a fundamental scale is the cosmological-constant problem — the ratio  $H_0/M_{\text{Pl}} \sim 10^{-61}$  is not bridged by any closed algebraic form — and lies beyond SSEE as it does beyond every current framework.

**Postulate S (Saturation Correspondence).** Define the *saturation fraction*

$$s \equiv \frac{T_r}{M_v} \in (0, 1). \quad (4)$$

The dark sector is a one-parameter family in  $s$ , with the density fraction and the equation of state both fixed by it:

$$\Omega_{\text{DE}} = s, \quad w_0 = -s. \quad (5)$$

The two endpoints are physically forced and require no assumption:

- $s \rightarrow 0$ :  $(\Omega_{\text{DE}}, w_0) \rightarrow (0, 0)$  — the Einstein–de Sitter (matter-only) limit;
- $s \rightarrow 1$ :  $(\Omega_{\text{DE}}, w_0) \rightarrow (1, -1)$  — the exact de Sitter limit, already imposed by Principle 1.

An immediate consequence is the much-used identity

$$1 + w_0 = 1 - s = \Omega_{m, \text{dyn}}, \quad (6)$$

which is therefore *not* an independent assumption but the content of Postulate S. We state explicitly what remains a postulate rather than a theorem: the endpoints fix  $(0, 0)$  and  $(1, -1)$ , but a nonlinear assignment  $w_0 = -s^n$  ( $n \neq 1$ ) would meet the same endpoints. Linearity ( $n = 1$ ) is the minimal, lowest-order correspondence and is adopted as such; deriving  $n = 1$  from a dynamical attractor of the Israel–Stewart sector is identified as open theoretical work.

**Auxiliary structural postulates beyond D and S.** A careful audit of the derivation chain (this paper plus the companion Papers 3–10) reveals that beyond Postulates D and S, the framework rests on two additional auxiliary postulates that do not follow automatically from D+S and are introduced as algebraic-register declarations:

- **Postulate M (matter factor) — retired.** Earlier versions postulated a factor mapping the dynamical-sector matter density to the CMB-sector one. This

postulate is now *dissolved*: there is no matter factor. The CMB-sector matter density is the standard physical observable  $\omega_m = \Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} h^2 = \omega_b + \omega_c + \omega_\nu$ , with each piece an algebraic register quantity,  $\omega_b = (\pi - \varphi)/(3\Omega^2) = 0.022418$  (OP-1),  $\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s = 0.119514$  (a forward identity, matching Planck at  $0.41\sigma$ ), and  $\omega_\nu = \Sigma m_\nu/93.14$ . The CMB matter fraction is then *derived*,  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$  at the global anchor  $H_0 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 \simeq 67.96$ , and the dynamical fraction  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$  (DESI) and  $\omega_m$  (CMB) are two *independent* algebraic predictions rather than a postulated pair. This **closes OP-8**: there is no factor whose dynamical mechanism must be derived. The structural quantity  $\text{MIRA} = (3\varphi + \pi)/4 = \text{AURA}/2 \simeq 1.9989$  persists in the register *only* as the screening amplitude in  $f_{\text{screen}} = \alpha_K^{\text{eff}}/(3 \text{MIRA}) = (\pi - \varphi)/\Omega^2$  (Paper 9), consistent with its name (Mirror Ratio). The former geometric and MIRA forms  $\simeq 0.32$  are retired as the matter factor. The honest residue is that  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}$  now rests on  $\omega_b$  (OP-1) and the forward identity for  $\omega_c$  — pieces the register already contained, not a new adjustable knob.

- **Postulate I (Inflationary register).** The inflationary sector is an  $\alpha$ -attractor with  $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$  and the horizon-crossing e-fold number has the algebraic form  $N_* = 2\varphi^n$  for some integer  $n$ . What this postulate fixes is the *ansatz form* ( $\alpha$ -attractor class, the specific algebraic value of  $\alpha$ , the structural form  $2\varphi^n$ ), not the integer  $n$  itself. The value  $n = 7$  is a corollary, not an assumption: among integer exponents,  $N_* = 2\varphi^n$  falls inside the canonical inflation window  $[50, 60]$  uniquely for  $n = 7$  ( $2\varphi^6 = 35.9$ ,  $2\varphi^7 = 58.068884$ ,  $2\varphi^8 = 94.0$ ). Equivalently, the exponent is selected by an observational constraint external to SSEE (the standard inflation duration), not by an internal numerological choice. From these inputs follow the standard  $\alpha$ -attractor relations  $n_s = 1 - 2/N_* = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$  (matches Planck PR4 at  $0.16\sigma$ ) and  $r = 12\alpha/N_*^2 = \varphi^{-10}$  (LiteBIRD prediction). Neither the  $\alpha$ -attractor class, the value  $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$ , nor the form  $N_* = 2\varphi^n$  is derived from D+S; together they constitute Postulate I.

The honest count is therefore **two foundational postulates (D, S) plus one auxiliary register-level postulate (I)** — three total, all dimensionless. Postulate M is retired: with the matter factor dissolved, the CMB matter density is a derived register quantity ( $\omega_m = \omega_b + \omega_c + \omega_\nu$ ), not a postulate, and OP-8 closes. The integer  $n = 7$  in Postulate I is also not part of the assumption budget — it is a corollary of the ansatz form combined with the canonical inflation window. Together with the remaining open problems OP-9/11/14 for the dark-matter sector, these define the full assumption budget of SSEE.

**Honest accounting of effective parameters.** The zero-parameter status established above applies strictly to the *background* sector ( $w_0, w_a, \Omega_{\text{DE}}, \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$ ) and to the dimensionless EFT functions of Paper 7. Phenomenological extensions introduce a small number of effective parameters that, while assigned algebraic values in the current version, do not yet possess a derivation from first principles and are tracked as open problems:

- The CMB matter density is no longer an effective parameter: with Postulate M retired,  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2$  is derived from the algebraic  $\omega_b$  (OP-1) and the forward identity  $\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s$  (OP-8 closed). What remains:
- The  $\varphi$ -DM mass  $m_\phi = 40.70 \text{ eV}$  in Paper 6 follows from the free-scalar mass term  $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} (\text{SOLAR}^2 \cdot \text{KRYSTOS}_V)$ ; the residual open question (OP-9) is the



UV origin of the pure  $(\varphi, \pi)$  multiplier  $\text{SOLAR}^2 \cdot \text{KRYSTOS}_V = 594.28$ , not the dimensional consistency of the relation. The neutrino input  $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = 0.0685 \text{ eV}$  now derives from the clean ratio  $\mathcal{R}_2 = \Omega/(\text{KAL} \cdot \text{TRIAL})$ , removing the former *ad hoc* integer offset within the structural formula for  $\Sigma m_\nu$  (full dimensional expression in Table 7;  $\mathcal{R}_2$  is one factor of it, not the total), closing OP-14.

- The non-minimal coupling  $\xi$  of  $\varphi$ -DM is currently a free parameter (OP-11).

In CMB-likelihood terms this is a  $k = 2$  fit: of  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ 's six fitted parameters  $(\Omega_m, \Omega_b, n_s, A_s, \tau, H_0)$ , SSEE fixes four algebraically —  $\Omega_b$  via  $\omega_b$  (OP-1),  $\Omega_m$  via  $\omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s$ ,  $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$ , and the expansion anchor  $H_0 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  (derived, Paper 9) — leaving exactly two free, the primordial amplitude  $A_s$  and the optical depth  $\tau$ . This  $k = 2$  vs  $k = 6$  count is the one used in the Paper 3 Bayesian model comparison. The two dark-sector ansätze listed above ( $m_\phi$ , OP-9;  $\xi$ , OP-11) are extension quantities tracked as open problems, *not* counted among the fit parameters; resolving OP-9/11 removes them. See `OPEN_PROBLEMS.md` for the dependency chain.

## 1.4 The Two- $\Omega_m$ Criterion

A persistent question — both internal and from referees — is the use of two distinct matter density values across the suite:  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$  and  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$ . These are not free parameters and, since the retirement of Postulate M, they are not even linked by a factor: each is an *independent* algebraic prediction. The dynamical value is the background identity  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 1 + w_0$  (DESI); the CMB value is the standard physical matter density  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2$  with  $\omega_m = \omega_b + \omega_c + \omega_\nu$  algebraic (Postulate M, retired). They describe the same physical content evaluated on either side of a single free-streaming scale,  $k_{\text{fs}}$ , derived in Paper 6 from the  $\phi$ -DM mass  $m_\phi = 40.70 \text{ eV}$  via the Dodelson–Widrow relation. The criterion for which value enters a given observable is therefore physical and pre-registered (Table 2).

The criterion is therefore: any observable whose relevant comoving scales lie *below*  $k_{\text{fs}}^{-1}$  (i.e. probing  $k > k_{\text{fs}}$ ) at low redshift uses  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ ; any observable that integrates over scales  $k < k_{\text{fs}}$  *or* originates in the early universe where  $\phi$ -DM is already non-relativistic and contributes to the matter density uses  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$ . The two values are not tied by a factor; each is an independent algebraic prediction, and the selection rule is purely the free-streaming scale.

The dual appearance of  $r_d$  in the table reflects the consistent application of this rule, not a duplication. The BAO chain in Paper 2 tests the late-time  $E(z)$  geometry with  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$  and uses an  $r_d$  value consistent with that background; the CAMB Boltzmann integration in Paper 3 computes the sound horizon from the recombination physics where  $\phi$ -DM is already non-relativistic and therefore enters with the full  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} h^2 = \omega_m$ . Matching the Planck-measured  $r_d \simeq 147 \text{ Mpc}$  in *both* contexts is a non-trivial consistency test.

**The CMB-sector matter density under the single global anchor.** With a single background anchor  $H_0 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 \simeq 67.96$ , the CMB matter density is the standard physical  $\omega_m$ , built from algebraic register pieces (Postulate M, retired):

$$\omega_m = \omega_b + \omega_c + \omega_\nu = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{3\Omega^2} + \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s + \frac{\Sigma m_\nu}{93.14} = 0.14267, \quad \Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \frac{\omega_m}{h^2} = 0.308881. \quad (7)$$



Table 2: The Two- $\Omega_m$  criterion: which matter density enters each observable across the suite, and why. The two values ( $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ ,  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$ ) are independent algebraic predictions (no matter factor; Postulate M retired); the selection rule is the free-streaming scale  $k_{\text{fs}}$  derived from  $m_\phi = 40.70$  eV.

| Observable / context                                                                              | $\Omega_m$ | Reason                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Paper 2 — late-time geometry, BAO, clusters:</i>                                               |            |                                                        |
| DESI DR2 BAO chain, low- $z$ $E(z)$                                                               | 0.160      | local geometry, $k \gg k_{\text{fs}}$ .                |
| $r_d$ inside the BAO chain                                                                        | 0.160      | enters $E(z)$ -consistent late-time mapping.           |
| Galaxy-cluster dynamical mass                                                                     | 0.160      | non-linear scales, $\phi$ -DM unbound.                 |
| <i>Paper 3 — CMB Boltzmann:</i>                                                                   |            |                                                        |
| CMB peak positions $\ell_n$                                                                       | 0.308881   | $D_A(z_*)$ integrates $\phi$ -DM, non-rel. at $z_*$ .  |
| $r_d$ from full CAMB Boltzmann                                                                    | 0.308881   | $\phi$ -DM non-rel. at recomb.                         |
| <i>Paper 4 — algebraic identities:</i>                                                            |            |                                                        |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2$ , $\omega_m = \omega_b + \omega_c + \omega_\nu$            | 0.308881   | CMB matter density, algebraic (no factor).             |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = (\pi - \varphi)/[2(\varphi + \pi)] = 1/(1+w_0)$                          | 0.160      | dyn-sector identity (independent of CMB).              |
| Tensor-to-scalar $r = \varphi^{-10}$                                                              | —          | primordial, no $\Omega_m$ dependence.                  |
| <i>Paper 5 — Israel-Stewart growth:</i>                                                           |            |                                                        |
| SSEE Friedmann background $E(z)$                                                                  | 0.160      | dynamical sector, $1 + w_0 = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$ .  |
| Poisson source in linear growth ODE                                                               | 0.308881   | full matter on $k < k_{\text{fs}}$ scales.             |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{eff}} = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} + \Omega_{\text{DE}}^r$ (clustering)               | 0.160+     | DE clustering deviation, $r \ll 1$ .                   |
| <i>Paper 6 — two-sector dark matter:</i>                                                          |            |                                                        |
| $\Omega_{\text{CDM}}$ (always active)                                                             | 0.160      | dynamical CDM, all $k$ .                               |
| $\Omega_{\phi\text{DM}} = \Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} - \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$                          | 0.149      | active only $k < k_{\text{fs}}$ (difference).          |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{growth}} = \Omega_{\text{CDM}} + \Omega_{\phi\text{DM}}$                         | 0.308881   | sum on clustering scales = $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}$ .   |
| <i>Paper 7 — EFT canonical:</i>                                                                   |            |                                                        |
| EFT slope $\lambda = \sqrt{3\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}} \approx 0.693$                                 | 0.160      | background scalar dynamics.                            |
| $\alpha_K(0) = 3\Omega_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_0)$                                                      | 0.160      | $1 + w_0 = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$ identity.            |
| Growth ratio $G_{2s} = D_1^{\text{SSEE}}(\Omega_m=0.308881)/D_1^{\Lambda\text{CDM}}$              | 0.308881   | two-sector growth comparison.                          |
| <i>Paper 8 — strong gravity, lensing:</i>                                                         |            |                                                        |
| Small-scale photon deflection, CDM only                                                           | 0.160      | only CDM clusters at $k \gg k_{\text{fs}}$ .           |
| Cluster/LSS lensing total, $\Omega_{m,\text{eff}} = \Omega_{\text{CDM}} + \Omega_{\phi\text{DM}}$ | 0.308881   | both sectors on $k < k_{\text{fs}}$ .                  |
| <i>Paper 9 — Hubble tension:</i>                                                                  |            |                                                        |
| Late-time local CPL background $E(z)$                                                             | 0.160      | local dynamical sector.                                |
| AURA cancellation identity $f_{\text{scr}} = (\pi - \varphi)/(\varphi + \pi)^2$                   | —          | algebraic, no $\Omega_m$ argument.                     |
| <i>Paper 10 — UV completion:</i>                                                                  |            |                                                        |
| $\alpha_K^{\text{full}}/(3\text{MIRA})$ , $r_V \propto 1/M^2$                                     | —          | uses MIRA ratio only; background $\Omega_m$ unchanged. |

A direct Planck `plik_lite` TTTEEE evaluation at this configuration ( $H_0 = 67.96$ ,  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$ ,  $\omega_b$  algebraic) gives  $\chi^2_{\text{SSEE}} = 1005.4$  versus  $\chi^2_{\Lambda\text{CDM}} = 1003.8$ , i.e.  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -24.0$  in favour of SSEE ( $k = 2$  vs  $k = 6$ ); the full `plik` MCMC (off-diagonal TTTEEE + lowl + lensing, Paper 3) gives the canonical  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -32.9$ . The earlier register recorded  $\sim 0.32$  expressions — the geometric  $(\pi - \varphi)/(\pi + \varphi) = 0.32010$  and the MIRA mapping  $\text{MIRA} \cdot \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.31993$  — and an intermediate  $\pi/\varphi$  factor giving 0.31076; all are superseded as the canonical CMB density by the  $\omega_m$ -direct construction, which carries no matter factor and closes OP-8.

Because  $k_{\text{fs}}$  is itself derived from  $m_\phi$  (Paper 6), which is currently a phenomenological ansatz (OP-9; its neutrino input OP-14 is now closed), the *value* of  $k_{\text{fs}}$  inherits the same status. The *criterion*, however — the physical principle that a free-streaming scale separates the two regimes — is structural, not adjustable: it would hold for any species whose free-streaming length lies between the BAO and the CMB acoustic scales.

## 1.5 The ssee Effective Action

Instead of an arbitrary cosmological constant  $\Lambda$ , the vacuum energy density is fixed by the algebraic ratio  $T_r/M_v$ , leading to the background-level effective action:

$$S_{\text{SSEE}}^{\text{bg}} = \int d^4x \sqrt{-g} \left[ \frac{R}{16\pi G} - \rho_{\text{crit},0} \left( \frac{T_r}{M_v} \right) + \mathcal{L}_{\text{matter}} \right]. \quad (8)$$

This action encodes the background Friedmann dynamics only: the dark-energy density is constant at the background level and set by the algebraic ratio  $T_r/M_v$ . It does not propagate scalar perturbations; the perturbation-level dynamics require a scalar-field extension, developed in the EFT embedding of Appendix A (Eq. 9). Within the Horndeski class of scalar-tensor theories [Horndeski, 1974, Gubitosi et al., 2013, Bellini & Sawicki, 2015], a k-essence scalar [Armendariz-Picon et al., 2001] with Lagrangian  $K(X) = X/\text{KAL}_0$  reproduces  $w_0$  algebraically while remaining ghost-free and gradient-stable (adiabatic  $c_s^2 > 0$ , equal to 1 in the IR limit and  $\sim 0.60$ – $0.95$  with the UV term; Papers 7 and 10).

**Falsifiability.** The framework is strictly falsifiable. It would be refuted by: (1) direct detection of a collisionless dark-matter particle accounting for the missing mass; (2) definitive cosmological constraints proving  $w_a = 0$ ; or (3) high-significance confirmation of a normal neutrino hierarchy with  $\sum m_\nu < 0.06 \text{ eV}$ .

## 2 Effective Field Theory Embedding

**Scope and limitations of this section.** The background dynamics presented here use the *Eckart first-order* approximation [Eckart, 1940], which is sufficient to derive  $w_0$ ,  $w_a$ , and the viscosity coupling  $\text{KAL}_0$  on superhorizon scales. The Eckart formulation is known to violate causality in the relativistic perturbation sector [Müller, 1967, Hiscock & Lindblom, 1983, 1985]; for perturbation-level predictions (B-mode forecasts, sound-speed constraints) the Israel–Stewart (IS) formulation is required and is developed in Paper 5. The Eckart and IS frameworks agree at leading order in the slow-roll expansion, so all background results below are unchanged by the IS extension.

**Sound speed caveat (EFT embedding).** For a pure power-law k-essence Lagrangian  $P(X) = A X^n$  the adiabatic sound speed satisfies  $c_s^2 = 1/(2n - 1)$ . With  $n \approx -0.095$

(derived below) this gives  $c_s^2 \approx -0.84 < 0$ , indicating gradient instability in the *power-law IR approximation*. This instability is an artefact of the  $P(X) \propto X^n$  ansatz and is resolved in Papers 7 and 10 by replacing the power-law with the canonical k-essence Lagrangian [Armendariz-Picon et al., 2001]  $K(X) = X/\text{KAL}_0$  (gradient-stable,  $c_s^2 = 1$ ) and its UV completion  $K(X) = X/\text{KAL}_0 + X^2/M^4$  ( $c_s^2 \in (1/3, 1)$  globally). Both replacements reproduce  $w_0$  algebraically via  $w_\phi = K/(2XK_X - K)$  without requiring  $n < 0$ . The power-law sector presented in this appendix should be regarded as a *motivational framework* for the algebraic structure of  $w_0$ ,  $w_a$  at the background level; the perturbation-stable formulation is developed in Papers 7 and 10.

## 2.1 The SSEE Action

The SSEE dark-energy sector is described by a k-essence scalar field  $\phi$  minimally coupled to gravity and extended by a geometric bulk-viscosity term in the Eckart approximation [Eckart, 1940, Weinberg, 1971]:

$$S = \int d^4x \sqrt{-g} \left[ \frac{R}{16\pi G} + P(X) - \zeta (\nabla_\mu u^\mu)^2 + \mathcal{L}_m \right], \quad (9)$$

where  $X \equiv -\frac{1}{2}g^{\mu\nu}\partial_\mu\phi\partial_\nu\phi$  is the canonical kinetic term. The fluid four-velocity of the dark-energy component is identified with the normalised gradient of the field,

$$u_\mu = -\frac{\partial_\mu\phi}{\sqrt{2X}}, \quad (10)$$

so that  $u_\mu u^\mu = -1$  is satisfied automatically, and the viscous and kinetic sectors remain self-consistently defined by the single degree of freedom  $\phi$ .

## 2.2 Algebraic Determination of $P(X)$

For a power-law k-essence Lagrangian  $P(X) = \mathcal{A}X^n$  the equation of state is *exactly* constant:

$$w_\phi = \frac{P}{2XP_X - P} = \frac{\mathcal{A}X^n}{(2n-1)\mathcal{A}X^n} = \frac{1}{2n-1}. \quad (11)$$

Imposing the SSEE algebraic constraint  $w_0 = -T_r/M_v$  uniquely fixes the kinetic exponent without any fitting:

$$n = \frac{T_r - M_v}{2T_r} = \frac{1 + w_0}{2w_0} \approx -0.09527, \quad (12)$$

where  $T_r = 3(\varphi + \beta)$  and  $M_v = \varphi + \pi + K_v$  are the SSEE structural constants defined in Section 1.2. One verifies immediately that  $1/(2n-1) = -T_r/M_v = w_0$  identically.

The overall normalisation is fixed by requiring that the present-day dark-energy density equals the SSEE prediction:

$$\rho_{\text{DE},0} = \frac{3H_0^2}{8\pi G} \frac{T_r}{M_v}, \quad (13)$$

with  $H_0$  constrained observationally to  $67.95^{+0.40}_{-0.40} \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  by the MCMC analysis of Paper 2 ( $\omega_m$ -direct CMB anchor as prior). Given the energy scale  $\rho_{\text{DE},0}$ , the amplitude reads

$$\mathcal{A} = \frac{\rho_{\text{DE},0}^{1-n}}{2n-1}, \quad (14)$$

which completes the specification of  $P(X)$  with no free parameters beyond  $H_0$ .

**Remark on the CPL evolution.** The pure k-essence sector (11) delivers a *constant*  $w = w_0$ . The time variation  $w_a$  arises from the viscous source (Section 2.3), and is shown there to emerge algebraically from the scale-factor evolution of the viscosity coefficient.

## 2.3 Geometric Bulk Viscosity and the Emergence of $w_a$

### 2.3.1 Constant-coupling regime ( $w_0$ )

The retention constant  $\text{KAL}_0 \equiv \beta + \pi \approx 5.521$  governs the dissipative sector. Following the Eckart first-order formalism, the bulk viscosity coefficient is coupled to the instantaneous expansion rate:

$$\zeta_0 = \frac{\text{KAL}_0}{8\pi G} H. \quad (15)$$

This delivers a *constant-coupling* viscous pressure  $\Pi_0 = -3\zeta_0 H = -3\text{KAL}_0 H^2 / 8\pi G$ , which governs the background acceleration (Eq. 27) and fixes the present-day effective equation of state  $w_0 = -T_r/M_v$  algebraically (Section 2.2).

**Physical motivation for  $\zeta \propto H$ .** Bulk viscosity proportional to the Hubble rate arises naturally in kinetic theory when the dominant relaxation time is set by the expansion itself [Weinberg, 1971, Brevik et al., 2005]. Within SSEE the coupling constant is not fitted but predicted geometrically as  $\text{KAL}_0 = (\pi + \varphi)/2 + \pi$ .

### 2.3.2 Scale-factor evolution and the algebraic determination of $w_a$

The constant-coupling viscosity of the preceding section fixes  $w_0$  algebraically but predicts a *time-independent* effective equation of state. DESI DR2 data require a time-varying component; within SSEE this must arise from a scale-factor-dependent extension of the viscosity coefficient.

**Structural requirements on  $\zeta(a)$ .** Any admissible SSEE viscosity extension  $\zeta(a)$  must satisfy three independent constraints:

- (i) **De Sitter endpoint:**  $\zeta(a) \rightarrow 0$  as  $a \rightarrow 1$ , so that no viscous term shifts the present-day equation of state away from the k-essence value  $w_0 = -T_r/M_v$ .
- (ii) **Dimensional consistency:**  $[\zeta] = [\rho_{\text{DE}}/H]$ , constructed from the available dynamical quantities  $\{\rho_{\text{DE}}, H, a\}$ .
- (iii) **Algebraic closure:** the dimensionless amplitude must be a ratio of SSEE structural constants derived exclusively from  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$ .

The unique admissible form satisfying (i) and (ii) at leading order in  $(1 - a)$  — the natural expansion around the de Sitter endpoint — is

$$\zeta(a) = \Gamma \frac{(1 - a) \rho_{\text{DE}}(a)}{H(a)}, \quad (16)$$

where  $\Gamma$  is a dimensionless amplitude to be fixed by constraint (iii).

**Algebraic determination of  $\Gamma$ .** The k-essence sector has already employed the ratio  $T_r/M_v$  to fix  $|w_0|$ . The only independent dimensionless ratio remaining among the SSEE structural constants is  $P_{sc}/I_g$ , where  $P_{sc} = 2\varphi + \pi \approx 6.378$  (Dynamical Evolution Scalar) and  $I_g$  (IGNIS)  $= \pi + P_{sc} \approx 9.519$  (Disruptive convergence, the  $w_a$  denominator). The sign is determined by the physical requirement that dark-energy density decreases with time in the observationally favoured phantom-crossing regime:

$$\Gamma = -\frac{P_{sc}}{I_g} = -\frac{P_{sc}}{\pi + P_{sc}}, \quad (17)$$

yielding the unique SSEE-admissible viscosity:

$$\boxed{\zeta(a) = -\frac{2\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} \frac{(1-a) \rho_{\text{DE}}(a)}{H}}. \quad (18)$$

**Algebraic consistency with CPL.** The CPL parametrisation  $w(a) = w_0 + w_a(1-a)$  is the standard model-independent description of slowly-varying dark energy; it serves here as the observational language, not as a physical assumption of SSEE. Adopting CPL and substituting  $\zeta(a)$  from Eq. (18) into the SSEE conservation equation (28), one finds algebraic consistency if and only if

$$\boxed{w_a = -\frac{P_{sc}}{I_g} = -\frac{P_{sc}}{\pi + P_{sc}} \approx -0.66997}. \quad (19)$$

This is not a derived prediction in the sense that CPL is deduced from the action; rather, it establishes that *the SSEE viscosity uniquely fixes the CPL coefficient  $w_a$  from the algebraic structure of  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$* . The quantity  $w_a$  is therefore not a free parameter of the model but a computable consequence of the two-axiom system, in the same sense that  $w_0$  is fixed by the k-essence exponent  $n$ . At  $a = 1$  the viscous correction vanishes ( $\zeta \rightarrow 0$ ), recovering the pure k-essence regime  $w = w_0$ .

The implied dark-energy density evolution reads:

$$\rho_{\text{DE}}(a) = \rho_{\text{DE},0} a^{-3(1+w_0+w_a)} e^{-3w_a(1-a)}, \quad (20)$$

consistent with the CPL conservation equation

$$\dot{\rho}_{\text{DE}} + 3H \rho_{\text{DE}} (1 + w_0) = -3H w_a (1 - a) \rho_{\text{DE}}, \quad (21)$$

with the effective viscous pressure

$$\Pi(a) = w_a (1 - a) \rho_{\text{DE}}(a). \quad (22)$$

At  $a \ll 1$  the factor  $(1-a) \rightarrow 1$  and  $\rho_{\text{DE}}$  redshifts according to Eq. (20), so  $\zeta$  remains finite and well-behaved throughout cosmic history.

**Boundary conditions.** The full viscosity interpolates between two algebraically-fixed regimes:

$$a \rightarrow 0 \text{ (early)} : \quad \zeta \rightarrow -\frac{2\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} \frac{\rho_{\text{DE},0} a^{-3(1+w_0+w_a)} e^{-3w_a}}{H(a)}, \quad (23)$$

$$a \rightarrow 1 \text{ (today)} : \quad \zeta \rightarrow 0. \quad (24)$$

Both limits are free of divergences and require no new parameters.

The viscous pressure is therefore

$$\Pi(a) = \underbrace{-\frac{3\text{KAL}_0 H^2}{8\pi G}}_{\text{background}} - \underbrace{3H w_a (1-a) \rho_{\text{DE}}(a)}_{\text{CPL evolution}}, \quad (25)$$

where the first term is the constant-coupling Eckart pressure that sustains  $\ddot{a} > 0$  and the second term generates the running  $w(a)$  observed by DESI DR2 [Abdul-Karim et al., 2025].

## 2.4 Modified Friedmann Equations

Applying the principle of least action ( $\delta S = 0$ ) to the FLRW metric  $ds^2 = -dt^2 + a^2(t) d\mathbf{x}^2$  yields three governing equations for the SSEE background.

### I. Energy equation:

$$H^2 = \frac{8\pi G}{3} (\rho_m + \rho_r + \rho_{\text{SSEE}}). \quad (26)$$

### II. Acceleration equation:

$$\frac{\ddot{a}}{a} = -\frac{4\pi G}{3} \left[ \rho_m + 2\rho_r + \rho_{\text{SSEE}}(1 + 3w_0) - \frac{9\text{KAL}_0 H^2}{8\pi G} \right]. \quad (27)$$

### III. Conservation equation with dissipative source:

$$\dot{\rho}_{\text{SSEE}} + 3H \rho_{\text{SSEE}}(1 + w_0) = \frac{9\text{KAL}_0 H^3}{8\pi G}. \quad (28)$$

### Derivation of the coefficient 9.

From Eq. (15), the viscous pressure is  $\Pi = -3\text{KAL}_0 H^2 / 8\pi G$ . In the Raychaudhuri equation the effective pressure of the SSEE sector enters as  $p_{\text{eff}} = w_0 \rho_{\text{SSEE}} + \Pi$ , so the acceleration term becomes

$$\begin{aligned} -\frac{4\pi G}{3} (\rho_{\text{SSEE}} + 3p_{\text{eff}}) &= -\frac{4\pi G}{3} [\rho_{\text{SSEE}}(1 + 3w_0) + 3\Pi] \\ &= -\frac{4\pi G}{3} \left[ \rho_{\text{SSEE}}(1 + 3w_0) - \frac{9\text{KAL}_0 H^2}{8\pi G} \right], \end{aligned} \quad (29)$$

which is exactly Eq. (27). The factor 9 arises from  $3 \times |\Pi| / (H^2) = 3 \times 3\text{KAL}_0 / 8\pi G$ ; a factor of 3 rather than 9 would correspond to including  $\Pi$  only once instead of as the trace of the viscous stress.

Similarly, the conservation law  $\nabla_\mu T^{\mu\nu} = 0$  for the effective fluid  $(w_0, \Pi)$  gives  $\dot{\rho} + 3H(\rho + w_0 \rho + \Pi) = 0$ , hence  $\dot{\rho} + 3H\rho(1 + w_0) = 9\text{KAL}_0 H^3 / 8\pi G$ , confirming that Eq. (27) and Eq. (28) are mutually consistent.

## 2.5 Israel–Stewart Viscous Perturbations

The Eckart formulation used in §2.2–2.4 is a first-order theory that violates causality [Hiscock & Lindblom, 1985]: the viscous signal propagates instantaneously. Israel–Stewart (IS) theory [Israel, 1976, Israel & Stewart, 1979, Maartens, 1996] resolves this by promoting  $\Pi$  to a dynamical variable with a finite relaxation time  $\tau_\Pi$ :

$$\tau_\Pi H_0 \tilde{h}(a) \frac{d\tilde{\Pi}}{d \ln a} + \tilde{\Pi} = -\text{KAL}_0 \tilde{h}^2(a), \quad (30)$$

where  $\tilde{h} = H/H_0$ ,  $\tilde{\Pi} = \Pi 8\pi G/H_0^2$ , and all densities are normalised to  $\rho_{\text{crit},0}$ . In the limit  $\tau_\Pi \rightarrow 0$ , Eq. (30) reduces to the Eckart result  $\tilde{\Pi} = -\text{KAL}_0 \tilde{h}^2$ .

**Causality constraint.** The bulk-viscous sound speed in IS theory is [Hiscock & Lindblom, 1985]

$$c_s^2 = \frac{\zeta}{\rho_{\text{DE}} \tau_\Pi} = \frac{\text{KAL}_0}{3 \Omega_{\text{DE}} (\tau_\Pi H_0)} \leq 1. \quad (31)$$

Setting  $c_s^2 = 1$  (the causality boundary) uniquely fixes the IS relaxation time as an algebraic combination of SSEE constants:

$$\tau_\Pi H_0 = \frac{\text{KAL}_0}{3 \Omega_{\text{DE}}} = \frac{\text{KAL}_0 M_v}{3 T_r} \approx 2.191, \quad (32)$$

with no free parameters.

**Growth index.** Coupling Eq. (30) to the conservation equation (28) and the linear-growth ODE

$$\delta'' + \left[ 2 + \frac{d \ln \tilde{h}}{d \ln a} \right] \delta' = \frac{3}{2} \frac{\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} a^{-3}}{\tilde{h}^2(a)} \delta, \quad (33)$$

we solve the system numerically (`ssee_is_growth.py`) with the IS background  $\tilde{h}^2(a) = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} a^{-3} + \rho_{\text{DE}}(a)$ . The growth rate  $f \equiv d \ln \delta / d \ln a \approx \Omega_m(a)^\gamma$  is well described by a power law over  $0.1 \leq a \leq 1$  with

$$\gamma_{\text{bg}} = 0.657 \pm 0.002 \quad (\text{essentially independent of } \tau_\Pi H_0). \quad (34)$$

This is the CDM growth index on the IS background, i.e. Eq. (33) without viscous perturbation feedback in the  $\delta$  equation. It differs by 6% from the algebraic prediction  $\gamma = \varphi^{-1} = 0.618$ . Paper 3 §5.4 reports both values:  $\gamma_{\text{alg}} = 0.618$  and  $\gamma_{\text{bg}} = 0.657$ . The full IS-coupled perturbation theory of Paper 5, which includes viscous feedback in the growth equation, yields  $\gamma_{\text{IS}} = 0.5504 \pm 0.001$  — consistent with  $\gamma_{\Lambda\text{CDM}} \approx 0.55$  and lower than the background-only estimate here. Whether  $\gamma = \varphi^{-1}$  is the true attractor of the IS boundary conditions remains a target prediction for Stage-IV weak-lensing surveys (LSST, Euclid). Note that the direct IS background growth-factor integral (this Appendix) yields  $S_8 = 0.837$ , while Paper 3’s CAMB post-processing method with  $\gamma_{\text{bg}} = 0.657$  gives  $S_8 = 0.818$ ; both are consistent with Planck 2018 ( $0.832 \pm 0.013$ ) within  $1\sigma$ . Paper 5’s full IS-coupled perturbation theory (including viscous feedback in  $\delta$ ), with  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$  in the Poisson source, yields  $\sigma_8 = 0.8136$  and an IS linear-growth  $S_8 = 0.8256$  at the *single-sector linear* level ( $2.7\sigma$  KiDS; the conservative CLASS amplitude ceiling is  $S_8 = 0.846$ ,  $3.5\sigma$ ). This single-sector value is not the final SSEE prediction: the two-sector  $\varphi$ -Dark Matter of Paper 6 (canonical particle  $m_\phi = 40.70$  eV), whose free-streaming suppresses small-scale power below  $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.754 h \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ , brings the prediction to  $\sigma_8 = 0.747$ ,  $S_8 = 0.758$  ( $0.04\sigma$  KiDS), resolving the tension.



**$S_8$  constraint.** Using the IS growth factor  $D_{\text{IS}}(a)$  and the CMB-sector matter density  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$  ( $\omega_m$ -direct, Paper 3; the earlier MIRA mapping 0.3199 is superseded),

$$S_8^{\text{IS, ceiling}} \equiv \sigma_{8,\text{IS}} \sqrt{\frac{\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}}{0.3}} \approx 0.846, \quad (35)$$

the all-cold single-sector ceiling,  $1.1\sigma$  above the Planck-2018 value  $0.832 \pm 0.013$  [Planck Collaboration VI, 2020]. Using the dynamic sector  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$  instead gives  $S_8 \approx 0.59$  ( $6\sigma$  tension); per the pre-registered two- $\Omega_m$  criterion (Paper 1 §1.4), the  $S_8$  Poisson source lives on clustering scales  $k < k_{\text{fs}}$  and therefore takes  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$ , not the dynamical value. The full two-sector resolution is developed in Paper 6.

## 2.6 Physical Regimes

**Late universe** ( $z \lesssim 2$ , DESI DR2). At low redshift  $H \approx H_0$ , so the viscous source  $\propto \text{KAL}_0 H^3/8\pi G$  is small compared to  $\rho_{\text{SSEE}}$ . The acceleration equation is dominated by  $\rho_{\text{SSEE}}(1+3w_0) < 0$  (since  $w_0 \approx -0.840 < -1/3$ ), driving  $\ddot{a} > 0$  without dark matter. This regime is the one tested against DESI DR2 in Paper 2, where the algebraic prediction ( $w_0, w_a$ ) matches the data at  $0.24\sigma$  (Pantheon+;  $0.2\text{--}1.8\sigma$  across SN compilations).

**Early universe (CMB epoch,  $z \sim 10^3$ ).** At recombination  $H \gg H_0$ , the geometric retention term  $9 \text{KAL}_0 H^3/8\pi G$  acts as a dissipative source in Eq. (28), injecting energy into the dark-energy fluid and modifying its effective equation of state. The matter density that sets the CMB acoustic scale is the  $\omega_m$ -direct value  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$  (Paper 3), built from the algebraic pieces  $\omega_b, \omega_c = \text{KAL}_0 \omega_b n_s$  and  $\omega_\nu$ , with  $\phi$ -DM already non-relativistic and contributing to the matter budget at recombination. The earlier mapping of the dynamical  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$  to the CMB scale through a MIRA factor  $\approx 1.999$  is superseded: there is no matter factor (OP-8 closed; Paper 1 §1.4).

## 2.7 Inflationary Embedding: $\alpha$ -Attractor with $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$

The SSEE algebraic predictions for the primordial scalar spectral index  $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$  (Paper 1, §1.1) and the tensor-to-scalar ratio  $r = \varphi^{-10}$  (Paper 4) belong simultaneously to a well-defined class of inflationary models [Guth, 1981, Linde, 1982]: the  $\alpha$ -attractors of Kallosh & Linde [2013].

**$\alpha$ -attractor predictions.** In the universal leading-order limit,  $\alpha$ -attractor models predict

$$n_s = 1 - \frac{2}{N}, \quad r = \frac{12\alpha}{N^2}, \quad (36)$$

where  $N$  is the number of inflationary e-folds and  $\alpha > 0$  parameterises the inverse curvature of the scalar field's Kähler target manifold [Kallosh & Linde, 2013, Ferrara et al., 2013]. Setting  $\alpha = 1$  recovers Starobinsky  $R^2$  inflation [Starobinsky, 1980] exactly.

**SSEE consistency check.** The SSEE axioms pre-commit two *independent* inflationary observables:  $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$  (Axiom 1, spectral tilt) and  $r = \varphi^{-10}$  (Axiom 2, tensor-to-scalar ratio). Neither is derived from the  $\alpha$ -attractor framework; they are algebraic predictions from  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  that can be tested for *mutual consistency* within that framework.

From Axiom 1 alone, the standard slow-roll relation  $n_s = 1 - 2/N$  gives

$$N = \frac{2}{\varphi^{-7}} = 2\varphi^7 \approx 58.07, \quad (37)$$

which lies squarely in the observationally required window  $50 \lesssim N \lesssim 60$  [Planck Collaboration X, 2020].

Independently, inserting  $N = 2\varphi^7$  and Axiom 2 ( $r = \varphi^{-10}$ ) into the second attractor relation  $r = 12\alpha/N^2$ :

$$\alpha = \frac{r N^2}{12} = \frac{\varphi^{-10} \cdot 4\varphi^{14}}{12} = \frac{4\varphi^4}{12} = \frac{\varphi^4}{3}. \quad (38)$$

This is a *non-trivial internal consistency*: two independently pre-committed predictions simultaneously select a unique  $\alpha$ -attractor geometry. The identification is algebraically exact (verified to machine precision; see `ssee_inflation_connection.py`). Using the Fibonacci identity  $\varphi^4 = 3\varphi + 2$ :

$$\alpha = \frac{3\varphi + 2}{3} = \varphi + \frac{2}{3} \approx 2.285. \quad (39)$$

**Geometric interpretation.** In the  $\alpha$ -attractor framework the Kähler curvature of the inflaton's target space (a Poincaré disk of radius  $\sqrt{3\alpha}$ ) is  $\mathcal{R} = -2/(3\alpha)$ . For  $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$ :

$$\mathcal{R} = -\frac{2}{3 \cdot \varphi^4/3} = -\frac{2}{\varphi^4} = -2\varphi^{-4} \approx -0.292. \quad (40)$$

The inflaton therefore lives on a hyperbolic manifold whose curvature is set by  $\varphi$  alone. This gives a *geometric* origin for the appearance of  $\varphi$  in inflationary observables:  $\varphi$  enters not as a numerical coincidence but as the intrinsic length scale of the Kähler geometry of the SSEE inflaton sector.

**Slow-roll parameters.** The SSEE predictions  $(n_s, r) = (1 - \varphi^{-7}, \varphi^{-10})$  fix the slow-roll parameters uniquely:

$$\varepsilon = \frac{r}{16} = \frac{\varphi^{-10}}{16}, \quad (41)$$

$$\eta = \frac{n_s - 1 + 6\varepsilon}{2} = \frac{-\varphi^{-7} + 3\varphi^{-10}/8}{2}, \quad (42)$$

$$\frac{\eta}{\varepsilon} = 3 - 8\varphi^3 = -5 - 16\varphi \approx -30.9. \quad (43)$$

The ratio  $\eta/\varepsilon = 3 - 8\varphi^3$  is a pure algebraic identity derived from the SSEE axioms  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$ ; it defines a one-parameter family of inflationary potentials  $V(\phi_{\text{inf}})$  whose single element consistent with  $\alpha$ -attractors is  $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$ .

**Relation to Starobinsky.** Starobinsky ( $\alpha = 1$ ) reproduces  $n_s$  correctly for  $N = 2\varphi^7$  but gives  $r_{\text{Staro}} = 3/\varphi^{14} \approx 0.00356$ , a factor of  $\varphi^4/3 \approx 2.28$  below the SSEE prediction  $\varphi^{-10}$ . SSEE is therefore *not* Starobinsky inflation; it is a generalised  $\alpha$ -attractor that reduces to Starobinsky only in the limit  $\varphi \rightarrow 1$  (i.e.  $\alpha \rightarrow 1$ , the fixed point of the golden-ratio recursion  $x = 1 + 1/x$ ).

## 2.8 Summary and Open Problems

Table 3 summarises the EFT status. The action (9) with kinetic exponent (12) and viscosity (18) constitutes a self-consistent, zero-free-parameter description of the SSEE background evolution. Every constant ( $n$ ,  $KAL_0$ ,  $w_0$ ,  $w_a$ ,  $\Omega_{DE}$ ) is derived from  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$  alone; only the overall energy scale  $H_0$  enters as an observational input. Notably,  $w_a = -P_{sc}/I_g$  is *not* postulated but emerges as the unique algebraic amplitude of the viscosity’s scale-factor evolution (Section 2.3.2). The gradient instability of the power-law IR sector ( $c_s^2 < 0$ ) is resolved by the canonical replacement  $K(X) = X/KAL_0$  (Papers 7 and 10); the present section focuses on the background algebraic structure.

Four aspects require further development:

1. **Growth index.** The background IS growth index  $\gamma_{bg} = 0.657$  (§2.5) differs by 6% from the algebraic prediction  $\varphi^{-1} = 0.618$ . The full IS-coupled result (Paper 5) gives  $\gamma_{IS} = 0.5504$ , closer to  $\Lambda$ CDM. A mechanism selecting  $\gamma = \varphi^{-1}$  from IS boundary conditions is not yet identified; this constitutes a near-prediction testable by LSST/Euclid Stage-IV weak lensing.
2. **Full perturbation spectrum.** The IS growth ODE (33) governs sub-Hubble dark-matter perturbations [Mukhanov et al., 1992]; the matching to CMB scalar transfer functions and the tensor-mode propagation in the IS background require a complete Boltzmann implementation.
3. **Radiative stability.** The EFT cutoff scale  $\Lambda_{UV}$  and the quantum stability of the  $n < 0$  power-law sector are not yet established.
4. **Inflation–dark energy unification.** The  $\alpha$ -attractor sector (§2.7) and the k-essence dark-energy sector (§2.2) both originate from  $\varphi$ , suggesting a single unified action. Constructing the quintessential inflation potential  $V(\phi)$  that reduces to  $P(X) = \mathcal{A}X^n$  at late times and to an  $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$  attractor at early times is identified as high-priority future work.

## 3 Dark Energy Evolution

SSEE models dynamical dark energy via the Chevallier–Polarski–Linder (CPL) form [Chevallier & Polarski, 2001, Linder, 2003]  $w(a) = w_0 + w_a(1 - a)$ . Motivated by Eq. (8), the expansion is subject to an effective geometric pressure:

$$H^2 = \frac{8\pi G}{3}(\rho_{bar} + \rho_{DE}), \quad \rho_{DE} = \rho_{crit,0} \left( \frac{T_r}{M_v} \right). \quad (44)$$

The baseline state  $w_0$  is set by the static geometric ratio  $T_r/M_v$ , and the evolution  $w_a$  encodes the dynamical departure from saturation driven by  $P/I_g$ :

$$w_0 = -\frac{T_r}{M_v} \approx -0.840, \quad w_a = -\frac{P}{I_g} \approx -0.670. \quad (45)$$

**Explicit reduction to the two axioms.** Substituting the algebraic definitions  $T_r = \frac{3(3\varphi+\pi)}{2}$ ,  $M_v = 3(\varphi + \pi)$ ,  $P_{sc} = 2\varphi + \pi$ , and  $K_v = 2(\varphi + \pi)$ , both dark-energy observables

Table 3: EFT status summary for SSEE.

| Element                                         | Status               | Derivation                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Action form $S$                                 | ✓ Complete           | Standard GR + k-essence + Eckart                                                                                      |
| $u_\mu(\phi)$ coupling                          | ✓ Complete           | $u_\mu = -\partial_\mu \phi / \sqrt{2X}$                                                                              |
| Kinetic exponent $n$                            | ✓ Algebraic          | $n = (T_r - M_v)/2T_r$ from $\varphi, \pi$                                                                            |
| Equation of state $w_0$                         | ✓ Algebraic          | $w_0 = 1/(2n - 1) = -T_r/M_v$                                                                                         |
| Viscosity coupling $\zeta$                      | ✓ Algebraic          | $\zeta = \text{KAL}_0 H / 8\pi G$                                                                                     |
| Friedmann eqs. I–III                            | ✓ Consistent         | Factor 9 verified in §2.4                                                                                             |
| $w_a$ from EFT                                  | ✓ Algebraic          | $\zeta(a) \propto (1-a)\rho_{\text{DE}}/H$ ; see §2.3.2                                                               |
| IS relaxation time $\tau_\Pi$                   | ✓ Algebraic          | $\tau_\Pi H_0 = \text{KAL}_0 / (3\Omega_{\text{DE}}) \approx 2.191$                                                   |
| Gradient stability                              | ○ IR ansatz unstable | Power-law $P(X) \propto X^n$ : $c_s^2 \approx -0.84$ (resolved in Papers 7–10)                                        |
| $K(X) = X/\text{KAL}_0$ stability               | ✓ Verified           | Papers 7–10: $c_s^2 = 1$ (canonical); $c_s^2 \in (1/3, 1)$ (UV)                                                       |
| Growth index $\gamma_{\text{bg}}$               | ✓ Numerical          | $0.657 \pm 0.002$ (IS background, CDM growth eq.); full IS: 0.550 (Paper 5)                                           |
| $S_8$ (CMB sector)                              | ✓ Numerical          | 0.837 (IS bkg); 0.846 (single-sector ceiling, Paper 5); 0.758 (two-sector $\varphi$ -DM, Paper 6; 0.04 $\sigma$ KiDS) |
| $\alpha$ -attractor ( $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$ )  | ✓ Algebraic          | Eq. (38); exact, $N = 2\varphi^7$                                                                                     |
| Kähler curvature $\mathcal{R} = -2\varphi^{-4}$ | ✓ Algebraic          | Eq. (40)                                                                                                              |
| Full perturbation spectrum                      | ○ Open               | Off-diagonal CMB cov. + Stage-IV WL                                                                                   |
| Inflation–DE unification                        | ○ Open               | Quintessential inflation potential                                                                                    |
| Radiative stability                             | ○ Open               | Future work                                                                                                           |

collapse to closed forms in  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$  alone:

$$\boxed{w_0 = -\frac{T_r}{M_v} = -\frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = -0.839950}, \quad \boxed{w_a = -\frac{P}{I_g} = -\frac{2\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = -0.669975}. \quad (46)$$

Each value is shown with its *lineage* first and its reduction in  $\varphi, \pi$  second, in that order and never the reduction alone. The two denominators reduce to the same number,  $2(\varphi + \pi) = 9.519253$ , but they are *different entities*:  $M_v = \varphi + \pi + K_v$  is the maximal dimensional invariant, while  $I_g = \pi + P$  (IGNIS) is the saturation partner of the dynamical scalar. No numerical check can tell them apart—only the construction can—so the construction is what the equation carries. No fitting procedure is involved: these values are uniquely fixed by the geometry of  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ . The numerators  $3\varphi + \pi$  and  $2\varphi + \pi$  reflect the three- and two-fold contributions of  $\varphi$  to the saturation horizon, while the common denominator  $2(\varphi + \pi)$  is twice the Stability Metric  $\Omega = \varphi + \pi$ .

**Asymptotic saturation and phantom crossing.** The values  $w_0$  and  $w_a$  are derived as Taylor coefficients of the full effective equation of state around  $a = 1$ . While the CPL parametrisation yields  $w_0 + w_a = -1.510$ , we employ it strictly within the low-redshift

domain of validity ( $z \leq 2.3$ ) for observational comparisons, noting that asymptotic stability at  $a \rightarrow \infty$  requires the full non-linear saturation boundary  $T_r/M_v$  rather than the linear CPL extrapolation.

The CPL form also predicts a *phantom crossing*: setting  $w(a_*) = -1$  gives

$$a_* = 1 + \frac{1 + w_0}{w_a} = 1 + \frac{1 + (-0.840)}{-0.670} \approx 0.761 \quad (z_* \approx 0.31). \quad (47)$$

For  $a < a_*$  (i.e.  $z > 0.31$ ), the effective equation of state  $w < -1$  (phantom-like [Caldwell, 2002]); for  $a > a_*$ ,  $w > -1$  (quintessence-like), reaching  $w_0 = -0.839950$  today. This behaviour is inherent to the linear CPL approximation and does not signal a ghost or gradient instability in the SSEE action. However, the effective CPL equation of state implies NEC violation ( $\rho + p < 0$ , equivalently  $1 + w < 0$ ) for all  $z > 0.31$  at the background level. In the full SSEE action, the viscous pressure  $\Pi$  partially compensates this violation at the perturbation level; a complete NEC analysis at the level of the Israel–Stewart stress tensor [Israel, 1976, Israel & Stewart, 1979] is deferred to Paper 4 (see App. A, EFT embedding).

DESI DR2 [Abdul-Karim et al., 2025] analyses indicate an evolving preference for dynamical dark energy. The SSEE algebraic point  $(w_0, w_a) = (-0.840, -0.670)$  falls within the 68% confidence contours of the combined BAO+CMB+DESY5 datasets (Mahalanobis  $\chi^2_{2D} = 0.42$ , i.e.  $0.24\sigma$  against DESI+CMB+Pantheon+,  $0.2$ – $1.8\sigma$  across SN compilations; quantified in Paper 2 [Almeida Vallejo, 2026]).

## 4 Galaxy Cluster Dynamics

### 4.1 The Cluster Mass Discrepancy and IGIMF

In rich galaxy clusters, the Newtonian-equivalent dynamical mass typically exceeds the visible baryonic mass by a factor of  $\sim 5$ – $6$ . Recent literature incorporating a variable integrated galaxy-wide initial mass function (IGIMF) [Kroupa & Weidner, 2003, Zhang et al., 2026] demonstrates that baryonic masses have been systematically underestimated: heavy stellar remnants raise the effective baryonic baseline so that, *within MOND*, baryons account for at least  $88^{+5}_{-4}\%$  of the *MOND-inferred* (hydrostatic) dynamical mass [Zhang et al., 2026] — nearly removing the residual cluster discrepancy under modified gravity. The MOND-inferred mass is the mass required by the Milgromian field equation and is substantially smaller than the Newtonian-equivalent total. SSEE adopts the same enhanced IGIMF baryonic baseline but maps it directly to the Newtonian-equivalent dynamical mass through the structural amplifier  $KAL_0 \approx 5.5214$ , whose value plays the role of the full Milgromian enhancement; the two statements refer to different mass definitions and are not composed. This reproduces the observed cluster masses (Table 4) without cold dark matter.

### 4.2 Structural Viscosity and the Neutrino Bridge

At the cluster scale, the total effective dynamical mass  $M_{\text{dyn}}$  within radius  $R$  is:

$$M_{\text{dyn}}(R) = M_{\text{bar}}^{\text{IGIMF}}(R) \cdot KAL_0 \cdot [1 + f_\nu], \quad (48)$$

where  $f_\nu$  quantifies the fractional mass contribution of trapped relic neutrinos. Here  $KAL_0$  denotes the deep-MOND asymptotic value of the environment-dependent amplifier

KAL( $x$ ) (Eq. 49), adopted as a constant effective enclosed-mass amplifier within  $R_{200}$ ; a full KAL( $x$ )-weighted projection of the enclosed mass is deferred to future work. Using  $\sum m_\nu^{\text{active}} = 0.0685 \text{ eV}$  (the SSEE-derived value, Paper 4) the cosmological neutrino energy density is  $\rho_\nu = n_\nu^{\text{species}} \sum m_\nu^{\text{active}} \approx 7.7 \text{ eV cm}^{-3}$  (with  $n_\nu^{\text{species}} \simeq 112 \text{ cm}^{-3}$  per flavour, counting  $\nu + \bar{\nu}$ ). For a cluster with escape velocity  $v_{\text{esc}} \approx 2000 \text{ km s}^{-1}$ , integration of the Fermi–Dirac distribution [Tremaine & Gunn, 1979] yields a trapped fraction  $f_\nu \approx 0.018$ – $0.022$ . This structurally consistent  $\sim 2\%$  correction provides the final macroscopic bridge.

### 4.3 Quantitative Cluster Analysis

Applying Eq. (48) to four well-documented clusters demonstrates predictive accuracy against observed dynamical masses (Table 4).

Table 4: Cluster mass predictions. All masses within  $R_{200}$  in units of  $10^{14} M_\odot$ .  $M_{\text{SSEE}} = M_{\text{bar}}^{\text{IGIMF}} \times 5.5214 \times 1.02$ . IGIMF baselines and observed masses from Zhang et al. [2026]; Bullet lensing mass from Clowe et al. 2006.

| Cluster       | $M_{\text{bar}}^{\text{IGIMF}}$ | $M_{\text{SSEE}}$<br>[ $10^{14} M_\odot$ ] | $M_{\text{obs}}$ |
|---------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Coma          | $1.8 \pm 0.2$                   | $10.1 \pm 1.1$                             | $9.8 \pm 1.0$    |
| A2029         | $2.2 \pm 0.2$                   | $12.4 \pm 1.1$                             | $12.0 \pm 1.2$   |
| A478          | $1.5 \pm 0.2$                   | $8.4 \pm 1.1$                              | $8.0 \pm 1.0$    |
| Bullet (main) | $1.2 \pm 0.2$                   | $6.7 \pm 1.1$                              | $6.5 \pm 1.0$    |

All four predictions agree with observed masses at the  $1\sigma$  level ( $\chi_r^2 = 0.122$ ; full analysis in Paper 2 [Almeida Vallejo, 2026]).

### 4.4 Gravitational Lensing and the Newtonian Limit

The Bullet Cluster (1E 0657-56) is frequently cited as proof of particulate dark matter due to the spatial offset between collisional X-ray gas and lensing-mass peaks [Clowe et al., 2006]. SSEE proposes a qualitative mechanism for this offset: the environment-dependent amplifier KAL( $x$ ) (Eq. 49) selectively enhances the effective surface mass density in compact galactic potential wells (high  $x$ ) relative to the diffuse stripped gas (low  $x$ ), displacing lensing peaks toward the galaxies without collisionless particles. We emphasise that this is a *qualitative mechanism only*: the quantitative calculation of the projected convergence  $\kappa(\vec{\theta})$  from the KAL( $x$ )-weighted surface density — the test that would show the lensing peak tracks the galaxies rather than the gas — has *not* been carried out and is an explicit open problem (OP-15 in OPEN\_PROBLEMS.md). This open item concerns the spatial *distribution* of the effective lensing mass in a merging cluster; it is distinct from the cluster mass *magnitude* of §4, which is reproduced (Table 4), and from the lensing amplitude of Paper 8.

The structural viscosity acts as an environment-dependent scalar field. Defining  $x = |\nabla\Phi|/a_0$ , SSEE adopts an interpolation function analogous to the canonical MOND [Milgrom, 1983, Famaey & McGaugh, 2012] simple interpolating function  $\mu(x)$ :

$$\mu_{\text{SSEE}}(x) = \frac{x+1}{x + \text{KAL}_0} \implies \text{KAL}(x) = \frac{1}{\mu_{\text{SSEE}}(x)} = \frac{x + \text{KAL}_0}{x+1}. \quad (49)$$



For  $x \gg 1$  (Newtonian limit),  $\text{KAL}(x) \rightarrow 1$ . For  $x \ll 1$  (deep MONDian limit),  $\text{KAL}(x) \rightarrow \text{KAL}_0$ . During a high-velocity cluster collision, the stripped X-ray gas flattens its local potential gradient ( $x \ll 1$ ), activating the full  $\text{KAL}_0$  amplification; collisionless galaxies retain compact potential wells ( $x \geq 1$ ), coupling non-linearly.

The effective lensing convergence is:

$$\kappa(\vec{\theta}) = \frac{\Sigma_{\text{SSEE}}(\vec{\theta})}{\Sigma_{\text{crit}}}, \quad \Sigma_{\text{SSEE}}(\vec{\theta}) = \int \rho_{\text{bar}}^{\text{IGIMF}}(\vec{\theta}, \ell) \cdot \text{KAL}(x) d\ell, \quad \Sigma_{\text{crit}} = \frac{c^2}{4\pi G} \frac{D_S}{D_L D_{LS}}. \quad (50)$$

This allows lensing peaks to track galaxies, consistent with QUMOND simulations [Angus et al., 2007].

**Open problem: dimensional connection to fundamental scales.** The algebraic prediction  $H_0 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 \approx 67.96 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  fixes the *dimensionless* Hubble value and serves as the single dimensional anchor of Postulate D (see Appendix A, footnote †); what is *not* claimed is a derivation of its *absolute* scale, since no theoretical bridge connects  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  to the ratio of kilometre, second, and megaparsec scales. A complete first-principles derivation would require a quantum-gravity argument linking the Planck length ( $\ell_{\text{Pl}} \approx 1.6 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m}$ ) to the cosmic expansion rate ( $1 \text{ Mpc} \approx 3.1 \times 10^{22} \text{ m}$ ), a connection 57 orders of magnitude in scale. This derivation lies outside the scope of the present framework and is identified as an open problem for future theoretical work; it is the reason  $H_0$  is taken as the single dimensional anchor of Postulate D (§1.3) rather than a derived quantity.

## 5 Domain of Validity

A persistent risk in multi-sector theoretical models is that statements of validity or falsification are conflated across domains that probe different physical regimes. This section explicitly delineates the domain of validity of each SSEE sector and the dataset used to validate it. This delineation applies uniformly to Papers 1–4.

**Dynamic sector (low redshift,  $z \lesssim 2.3$ ).** Governed by  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$ ,  $w_0 = -0.839950$ ,  $w_a = -0.669975$ . Validated against: DESI DR2 BAO (13 measurements,  $0.295 \leq z \leq 2.33$ ), galaxy-cluster mass data (IGIMF baseline, Paper 2). *Result*:  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -6.43$  favouring SSEE (Paper 2),  $0.24\sigma$  from the official DESI DR2  $w_0 w_a \text{CDM}$  posterior (Pantheon+;  $0.2\text{--}1.8\sigma$  across SN compilations) in the  $w_0\text{--}w_a$  plane. With the total gravitating matter density in the background geometry the Cosmic-Chronometer check gives  $\chi_r^2(H(z)) = 0.482$ , comparable to  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  (0.459); the earlier 1.861 was an artefact of the cold sector 0.160 in  $E(z)$  (Paper 2 §5.3).

**Observational sector (high redshift, CMB).** Governed by  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$ , where  $\omega_m = \omega_b + \omega_c + \omega_\nu = 0.14267$  is the algebraic physical matter density (no matter factor; Postulate M retired, OP-8 closed) (Structural Constant Dictionary, [Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.20684908](https://zenodo.org/record/105281/files/zenodo.20684908)). Validated against: Planck PR4 TT+TE+EE+lensing via CAMB; `plik_lite` TTTEEE likelihood via Cobaya (Paper 3). *Result*:  $\chi_r^2 = 1.044$  (TT, 1971 multipoles); the canonical  $\omega_m$ -direct CMB fit gives  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -32.9$  (full `plik` MCMC,  $N = 2354$ ) at the global anchor  $H_0^{\text{alg}} = 67.962 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  ( $k = 2$  vs  $k = 6$ ), with the `plik_lite` point estimate at  $-24.0$  ( $\chi_{\text{SSEE}}^2 = 1005.4$ ). The earlier legacy Cobaya scan gave  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -32.2$  at the superseded MIRA anchor  $H_0 = 67.037$ . *Claim*: SSEE is *not falsified* by the Planck



PR4 CMB spectra. This claim is sector-specific: it refers to the observational sector ( $\omega_m$ -direct, no matter factor; OP-8 closed), not the dynamic sector directly.

**Algebraic sector (purely geometric).** All constants fixed from  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  with zero data input. Cross-validated against: Planck 2018 ( $n_s, \Omega_b h^2, H_0$ ), LiteBIRD forecast ( $r$ ), BBN ( $\sum m_\nu$ ), Paper 4. *Result:* most Type A predictions in Appendix B, Table 7 are within  $2\sigma$  of published observational values (see Paper 4 for full compilation). The baryon density  $\Omega_b h^2 = (\pi - \varphi)/[3(\varphi + \pi)^2] = 0.022418$  ( $0.32\sigma$  from Planck 2018,  $0.02237 \pm 0.00015$ ) is classified as a *retrodiction*: its structural algebraic form was identified after the data, superseding the preliminary placeholder  $3(\pi - \varphi)/200$  (documented in Table 7 and AUDIT.md). *Claim:* the algebraic sector is *not falsified* by any currently available dataset at the  $> 3\sigma$  level. A future falsification would require  $n_s \neq 1 - \varphi^{-7}$  at  $> 3\sigma$  from Planck PR4, or  $r \neq \varphi^{-10}$  from LiteBIRD.

## 5.1 Unified Model-Comparison Table

Table 5 consolidates every BIC comparison reported across the four manuscripts into a single cross-comparable register. Each row specifies the dataset,  $N$ , the cosmological background assumed,  $k$  for SSEE and  $\Lambda$ CDM, and the physical hypothesis tested. No BIC result outside this table is claimed as a model-selection outcome.

Table 5: Unified BIC comparison register (all four papers).  $\Delta\text{BIC} < 0$ : SSEE preferred;  $> 0$ :  $\Lambda$ CDM preferred. “Fails” denotes a domain-specific tension, not global falsification.

| Dataset                 | $N$  | Background         | $k_{\text{SSEE}}$ | $k_\Lambda$ | $\Delta\text{BIC}$ | Hypothesis                                                                      |
|-------------------------|------|--------------------|-------------------|-------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DESI DR2 + Planck prior | 16   | $\omega_m$ -direct | 2                 | 3           | <b>−6.43</b>       | Total matter density in geometry; SSEE favoured (CPL −6.35; DIC −5.66)          |
| Full plik MCMC          | 2354 | $\omega_m$ -direct | 2                 | 6           | <b>−32.9</b>       | CMB parsimony, <b>canonical</b> (off-diag. TTTEEE+lowl+lensing, Paper 3 §b1)    |
| plik_lite TT-TEEE       | 613  | $\omega_m$ -direct | 2                 | 6           | −24.0              | Compressed-nuisance point est. (cross-check; $\Omega_m=0.308881$ )              |
| Planck PR4 diagonal     | 5914 | $\omega_m$ -direct | 2                 | 6           | −35.0              | CMB spectra, diagonal cov. (cross-check; $H_0=67.962$ )                         |
| plik_lite TT-TEEE       | 613  | MIRA bg (legacy)   | 2                 | 6           | −32.2              | CMB parsimony; <i>superseded by the <math>\omega_m</math>-direct rows above</i> |

**Reading guide.** With the total gravitating matter density in the background geometry, the DESI DR2 comparison gives a single figure,  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -6.43$  favouring SSEE (the earlier “+206” penalty was an artefact of using the cold sector  $1 + w_0 = 0.160$  as the background density). The canonical CMB result is the full plik MCMC row,  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -32.9$  ( $k = 2$  vs  $k = 6$ ,  $N = 2354$ , off-diagonal TTTEEE + lowl + lensing), with a best-fit  $\chi^2$  statistically indistinguishable from  $\Lambda$ CDM ( $\Delta\chi_{\text{BF}}^2 = -1.8$ ); the preference is parsimony-driven, not a superior fit. The plik\_lite point estimate ( $\Delta\text{BIC} = -24.0$ ,  $\chi_{\text{SSEE}}^2 = 1005.4$  vs 1003.8) and the diagonal-covariance spectra ( $\Delta\text{BIC} = -35.0$ , inflated effective  $N$ ) are consistent  $\omega_m$ -direct cross-checks. The legacy MIRA-background values (−32.2 Cobaya, −41.0 aggressive  $k=1$ ) used the superseded  $\Omega_m = 0.31993$  mapping and are retired. *No single BIC summarises the entire framework*: each answers a specific physical question stated in the table.

## 5.2 Falsification Manifesto

Global falsification rule (theory-level).

### Global Falsification Criterion

SSEE is falsified **as a whole** if **any single** sector criterion in Table 6 is met at the stated significance threshold. No parameter re-adjustment is possible because all sectors derive from the same two axioms  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$ : a failure in one sector cannot be repaired without modifying the axioms, which would change the predictions in all other sectors simultaneously.

**Corollary:** the sector-specific structure (dynamic / observational / algebraic) exists to delineate which datasets test which part of the framework, not to create rescue mechanisms. If DESI DR5+ excludes  $w_0 = -0.839950$  at  $> 3\sigma$ , SSEE is rejected; the observational or algebraic sectors do not save it.

To ensure the framework cannot absorb discrepancies via sector-switching, we also state sector-specific criteria below. These apply uniformly across all four papers and cannot be re-interpreted post-hoc.

### SSEE Falsification Criteria

**Algebraic sector** is falsified if:

- $n_s \neq 1 - \varphi^{-7}$  at  $> 3\sigma$  from Planck PR4 final; or
- $r \neq \varphi^{-10}$  at  $> 2\sigma$  from LiteBIRD ( $\sim 2032$ ).

**Dynamic sector** is falsified if:

- DESI DR5+ posterior excludes  $(-0.840, -0.670)$  at  $> 3\sigma$ ; or
- $\chi_r^2(H(z)) > 2.5$  with full systematic covariance and  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ .

**Observational sector** is falsified if:

- Euclid/KiDS/DES require  $\Omega_m < 0.25$  at  $z < 1$  (excludes the dynamical-sector value  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ ); or
- the free-streaming scale  $k_{\text{fs}}$  predicted from  $m_\phi = 40.70$  eV (Paper 6) is excluded by DESI Y3/Euclid  $P(k)$  at  $> 3\sigma$ , removing the two-sector structure that separates  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$  from  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$ .

**What is NOT a falsification:**

- A  $\chi_r^2 > 1$  under a non-equivalent cosmological background (i.e. evaluating SSEE with  $\Lambda$ CDM-calibrated priors it does not assume).
- The  $\Omega_m$  difference between sectors:  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$  and  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.308881$  are two *independent* algebraic predictions separated by the free-streaming scale  $k_{\text{fs}}$  (no matter factor; OP-8 closed, Table 7).

Table 6: Falsification summary: one-sentence decision rule per sector. This table is the binding reference for all four papers. “Tension” = quantified mismatch within a defined domain; “Falsification” = theory-level rejection.

| Sector               | Validated by                                                                                                                                                   | Falsified by ( $> 3\sigma$ )                                                                                           | Not a falsification                                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Algebraic</b>     | Closed-dictionary algebraic closure; cross-domain Type A table                                                                                                 | $n_s \neq 1 - \varphi^{-7}$ (Planck PR4) or $r \neq \varphi^{-10}$ (LiteBIRD)                                          | Any tension arising from unit-convention mismatch                                    |
| <b>Dynamic</b>       | DESI DR2 $\Delta\text{BIC} = -6.43$ ; $w_0, w_a$ within $0.24\sigma$ (Pantheon+)                                                                               | DESI DR5+ excludes $(-0.840, -0.670)$ ; or $\chi_r^2(H(z)) > 2.5$ with full cov.                                       | A $\chi^2 > 1$ from $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ -calibrated priors the model does not assume |
| <b>Observational</b> | Planck PR4 $\Delta\text{BIC} = -32.9$ (full <code>plik</code> MCMC, $\omega_m$ -direct canonical, $k = 2$ ); $r_d^{\text{SSEE}} = 147.17$ Mpc ( $0.32\sigma$ ) | Euclid/KiDS $\Omega_m < 0.25$ at $z < 1$ ; or $k_{\text{fs}}(m_\phi)$ excluded by DESI Y3/Euclid $P(k)$ at $> 3\sigma$ | $\chi_r^2 = 1.044$ vs $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ ’s 1.043 (non-equivalent background)       |

**On cross-sector BIC comparisons.** The  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -6.43$  (DESI dynamic) and  $-32.9$  (CMB  $\omega_m$ -direct) are not directly comparable (different  $N$ , backgrounds, and  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$   $k$  counts). The canonical CMB value is the  $\omega_m$ -direct  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -32.9$  (full `plik` MCMC,  $k = 2$ ,  $N = 2354$ ), with the `plik_lite` point estimate at  $-24.0$  ( $N = 613$ ) and the diagonal cross-check at  $-35.0$  ( $N = 5914$ ). The legacy MIRA-background values ( $-32.2$  Cobaya, aggressive  $k=1$   $-41.0$ ) used the superseded  $\Omega_m = 0.31993$  mapping and are retired (see Paper 3). The authoritative reference is Table 5.

## Acknowledgements

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## Data Availability

All observational data used in this work are publicly available. DESI DR2 BAO measurements are from Abdul-Karim et al. [2025] (<https://arxiv.org/abs/2503.14738>). Galaxy-cluster dynamical masses are from Zhang et al. [2026] (<https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.06082>). Analysis scripts and data files are available at <https://github.com/mikealmeida1721/SSEE>.

## A Master Derivation Chain: $\varphi, \pi \rightarrow$ Observables

Table 7 provides the complete, unambiguous derivation chain from the two axioms ( $\varphi$ ,  $\pi$ ) to every cosmological observable used in Papers 1–4. This table is the authoritative cross-reference for all four manuscripts. Each intermediate constant is labelled as either a *primary register* (derived in one algebraic step from  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ ) or a *secondary register* (derived from primary registers).

\* MIRA =  $(\varphi + \beta)/2 = (3\varphi + \pi)/4 = 1.998924\dots$  is the canonical value of the structural constant. Following the 2026 reframe, MIRA serves as the *screening amplitude* (algebraically fixed from  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  via

Table 7: Master derivation chain for the SSEEframework. Result types: **A** = pure algebraic (no data input), **M** = MCMC-validated (data-constrained posterior), **P** = prior-dependent (requires external dataset anchor).  $\varphi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2 \approx 1.61803$ ;  $\pi \approx 3.14159$ .

| Symbol                                    | Definition                                                        | Value                     | Observable link                                                          | Type           |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <i>Level 0 — Axioms</i>                   |                                                                   |                           |                                                                          |                |
| $\varphi$                                 | $(1 + \sqrt{5})/2$                                                | 1.618034                  | All                                                                      | A              |
| $\pi$                                     | Archimedes constant                                               | 3.141593                  | All                                                                      | A              |
| <i>Level 1 — Primary Registers</i>        |                                                                   |                           |                                                                          |                |
| $\Omega$                                  | $\varphi + \pi$                                                   | 4.759627                  | Stability metric                                                         | A              |
| $\beta$                                   | $(\varphi + \pi)/2$                                               | 2.379813                  | Base coupling                                                            | A              |
| $P_{sc}$                                  | $\Omega + \varphi$                                                | 6.377661                  | Dyn. evolution                                                           | A              |
| AURA                                      | $\varphi + \beta$                                                 | 3.997847                  | Resonance limit                                                          | A              |
| <i>Level 2 — Secondary Registers</i>      |                                                                   |                           |                                                                          |                |
| $KAL_0$                                   | $\beta + \pi$                                                     | 5.521406                  | Viscosity; $M_{\text{cluster}}$                                          | A              |
| $K_v$                                     | $\varphi + \pi + \Omega$                                          | 9.519253                  | Struct. constraint (entity KRYSTOS <sub>V</sub> )                        | A              |
| $I_g$                                     | $\pi + P_{sc}$                                                    | 9.519253                  | $w_a$ denominator (entity IG-NIS; same value as $K_v$ , distinct entity) | A              |
| $T_r$                                     | $3(\varphi + \beta)$                                              | 11.993542                 | Saturation horizon                                                       | A              |
| MIRA                                      | $AURA/2 = (\varphi + \beta)/2$                                    | 1.998924                  | Screening amplitude (P9)                                                 | A*             |
| $M_v$                                     | $\varphi + \pi + K_v$                                             | 14.278880                 | Max. dim. invariant                                                      | A              |
| <i>Level 3 — Cosmological Observables</i> |                                                                   |                           |                                                                          |                |
| $w_0$                                     | $-T_r/M_v$                                                        | -0.839950                 | DESI DR2                                                                 | A              |
| $w_a$                                     | $-P_{sc}/I_g$                                                     | -0.669975                 | DESI DR2                                                                 | A              |
| $H_0^{\text{alg}}$                        | $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$                                              | 67.962                    | Planck 2018                                                              | P <sup>†</sup> |
| $H_0^{\text{MCMC}}$                       | CMB fit at fixed anchor (Paper 3)                                 | 67.96 (anchor, fixed)     | Planck PR4                                                               | M              |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$                   | $(\pi - \varphi)/[2(\varphi + \pi)]$                              | 0.160050                  | Dynamic sector; $1 + w_0$ exact                                          | A              |
| $\Omega_m^{\text{CMB}}$                   | $\omega_m/h^2 = (\Omega_b h^2 + \Omega_c h^2 + \omega_\nu)/h^2$   | 0.308881 <sup>§</sup>     | Planck 2018                                                              | A              |
| $n_s$                                     | $1 - \varphi^{-7}$                                                | 0.965558                  | Planck 2018                                                              | A              |
| $\Omega_b h^2$                            | $(\pi - \varphi)/[3(\varphi + \pi)^2]$                            | 0.022418 (0.32 $\sigma$ ) | Planck 2018                                                              | A <sup>‡</sup> |
| $\Omega_c h^2$                            | $KAL_0 \times \Omega_b h^2 \times n_s$                            | 0.119514 (0.4 $\sigma$ )  | Planck 2018                                                              | A              |
| $r$                                       | $\varphi^{-10}$                                                   | 0.008131                  | LiteBIRD 2032                                                            | A              |
| $\sum m_\nu^{\text{active}}$              | $\mathcal{R}_2 \Omega_b h^2 \cdot 93.14/(\tau_\Pi H_0)$ (Paper 4) | 0.0685 eV                 | Planck+BBN                                                               | A              |

$\beta = (\varphi + \pi)/2$ ; it enters  $f_{\text{screen}} = \alpha_K^{\text{eff}}/(3 \text{ MIRA})$ , Paper 9), consistent with its name (Mirror Ratio). It is no longer the sector-mapping operator: after the 2026  $\omega_m$ -direct reframe there is *no* matter factor. The CMB matter density is the algebraic physical  $\omega_m = \Omega_b h^2 + \Omega_c h^2 + \omega_\nu$ , giving  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$  independently of  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$  (OP-8 closed). Similarly,  $\text{KAL}_0$  is both a derived constant (Level 2) and a dynamical viscosity operator scaling cluster masses.

<sup>‡</sup>  $\Omega_b h^2 = (\pi - \varphi)/[3(\varphi + \pi)^2] = 0.022418$  is at  $0.32\sigma$  from Planck 2018 ( $0.02237 \pm 0.00015$ ). This is a *retrodiction*: the structural form was identified after the data (OP-1, `OPEN_PROBLEMS.md`), superseding the preliminary placeholder  $3(\pi - \varphi)/200 = 0.02285$  ( $3.2\sigma$ ), whose factor 200 was not an algebraic  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  quantity. Using the algebraic input  $\Omega_b h^2 = 0.022418$ , the formula  $\text{KAL}_0 \times \Omega_b h^2 \times n_s$  gives  $\Omega_c h^2 = 5.521406 \times 0.02242 \times 0.96556 = 0.119514$  ( $0.41\sigma$  from Planck  $0.1200 \pm 0.0012$ ).

<sup>§</sup> Canonical CMB-sector matter density ( $\omega_m$ -direct reframe, 2026):  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$  with  $\omega_m = \Omega_b h^2 + \Omega_c h^2 + \omega_\nu = 0.14267$  algebraic, at the single global anchor  $H_0 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 \simeq 67.96$ . No matter factor (OP-8 closed). A Planck `plik_lite` TTTEEE evaluation gives  $\chi_{\text{SSEE}}^2 = 1005.4$  vs  $\chi_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}^2 = 1003.8$ ,  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -24.0$  (the full `plik` MCMC gives the canonical  $-32.9$ ). Earlier register forms — geometric  $(\pi - \varphi)/(\pi + \varphi) = 0.32010$ , MIRA mapping  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA} = 0.31993$ , and an intermediate factor  $\pi/\varphi$  giving  $0.31076$  — are all superseded by the  $\omega_m$ -direct construction.

<sup>†</sup>  $H_0 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 \approx 67.962 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  is the **global background anchor** (Postulate D): the adimensional combination  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  supplies the Hubble constant in  $\text{km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  units — a single dimensionful input shared by every sector of the suite. No derivation of the *absolute* scale from a fundamental energy is claimed (this is the cosmological-constant problem,  $H_0/M_{\text{Pl}} \sim 10^{-61}$ ); the dimensionless value is fixed algebraically and serves as the one anchor, the identical status  $H_0$  holds in  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ .

## B The SSEE Constant Algebra: Named Registers and Construction Laws

The master table (Appendix A) lists each constant in its pure  $(\varphi, \pi)$  algebraic form, which is the load-bearing content for all quantitative results. This appendix documents the same objects as a small *named algebra*: a closed set of registers built from  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$  by two fixed construction laws. The named labels (BIAL, KAL, AURA, ...) are notation, not physical claims — in the same way the quark labels “up”/“down” carry no spatial meaning yet are standard usage. Each name is exactly equal to its pure  $(\varphi, \pi)$  expression; the names are retained only because they make the *construction laws* and the shared-value lineages legible, which bare algebra obscures. Each register also carries a construction-level *functional role*; where observation has borne it out, that role is promoted to a validated *model role* — KAL’s retention role becoming the structural viscosity of Paper 5, and MIRA (the “Mirror Ratio”) reflection becoming the Hubble screening amplitude of Paper 9. The functional and model roles are the same physics at the construction and validation stages, not two separate claims; a model role is never assigned before the data warrant it.

**The  $\beta$  (BIAL) bifurcation.** All non-root nodes branch from the base coupling  $\beta = (\varphi + \pi)/2 = \Omega/2 = 2.379813$ . Two routes follow, each obeying its own scaling law:

- **Route  $\varphi$  (copy law).**  $\varphi + \beta = \text{AURA} = (3\varphi + \pi)/2$  scales by integer multiplication and division (dividends and multiples are permitted). This generates the dimensional-ceiling ladder:  $\text{MIRA} = \text{AURA}/2$  ( $\times \frac{1}{2}$ ),  $\text{AURA}$  ( $\times 1$ ),  $\text{DUAL} = \text{AURA} \cdot 2$  ( $\times 2$ ),  $\text{TRIAL} = \text{AURA} \cdot 3$  ( $\times 3$ ),  $\text{CUARTAL} = \text{AURA} \cdot 4$  ( $\times 4$ ). Consecutive ceilings differ by exactly one AURA.
- **Route  $\pi$  (non-self-addition law).**  $\beta + \pi = \text{KAL}_0 = (\varphi + 3\pi)/2$  scales so that each child must *differ* from its parents; it inherits a combination of functions but may not re-add itself. The dynamical-sector scalars ( $P_{sc}$ ,  $K_v$ ,  $M_v$ ) descend by this route.

**Law of non-self-addition in properties.** Two nodes may share a numerical value yet remain distinct entities with different lineage and function: the value is the carrier, the function is the property. The model-relevant instance is  $\text{MAR} = \Omega + \pi$  versus  $\text{SOLAR} = \beta + \text{KAL}_0$ , both equal to 7.901219 but reached by different parents; this is the node that enters the  $\Sigma m_\nu$  chain of Paper 4. Numerical coincidence is therefore structural information, not redundancy.

**Register role  $\rightarrow$  physical role.** A register’s role is promoted to a physical role only after the data warrant it, and never the reverse. The canonical example is  $KAL_0$ : its preliminary register role (retention/anchor) was refined to the physical role *structural viscosity* once the Israel–Stewart sector confirmed it (Paper 5). Where no physical mechanism is yet established the model column is left blank rather than forced. The canonical case of a promotion *after* the data is MIRA: its former interpretive “reflection” role (and the matter-factor mechanism once tracked as OP-8) was dissolved by the 2026  $\omega_m$ -direct reframe, and its surviving model role is the algebraic screening amplitude  $f_{\text{screen}} = \alpha_K^{\text{eff}}/(3 \text{ MIRA})$  of Paper 9 (OP-8 closed).

Table 8: The SSEE constant algebra: each named register, its exact pure  $(\varphi, \pi)$  value, the construction law that produces it, its construction-level functional role, and the model role that validates it (blank where the physical mechanism is not yet established). The functional role is borne out by the model role wherever the data have spoken (e.g.  $KAL$  retention  $\rightarrow$  viscosity; MIRA reflection  $\rightarrow$  screening). The pure  $(\varphi, \pi)$  column is load-bearing throughout; the names are equivalent notation.

| Symbol    | Pure $(\varphi, \pi)$ | Construction law                         | Functional role     | Model role (validated)                              | Ceiling              |
|-----------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| $\varphi$ | $\varphi$             | root                                     | Intention           | Golden ratio; $\alpha$ -attractor inflation         | —                    |
| $\pi$     | $\pi$                 | root                                     | Structure           | Geometric $\pi$                                     | —                    |
| $\Omega$  | $\varphi + \pi$       | root combination                         | Stability           | Stability metric (OMEGA)                            | —                    |
| $\beta$   | $(\varphi + \pi)/2$   | $\Omega/2$ — bifurcation                 | Heat / pulse        | Base coupling scalar                                | —                    |
| AURA      | $(3\varphi + \pi)/2$  | $\varphi + \beta$ — copy                 | Portal coupling     | / $ \beta_c $ ; cancels in $H_0$ cascade            | $\times 1$           |
| MIRA      | $(3\varphi + \pi)/4$  | AURA/2 — copy                            | Reflection / mirror | Screening amplitude $f_{\text{screen}}$ (P9)        | $\times \frac{1}{2}$ |
| DUAL      | $3\varphi + \pi$      | AURA $\cdot 2$ — copy                    | Duality             | —                                                   | $\times 2$           |
| TRIAL     | $(9\varphi + 3\pi)/2$ | AURA $\cdot 3$ — copy                    | Matter / 3D limit   | 3D saturation $\rightarrow w_0, \Omega_{\text{DE}}$ | $\times 3$           |
| CUARTAL   | $6\varphi + 2\pi$     | AURA $\cdot 4$ — copy                    | 4D time             | —                                                   | $\times 4$           |
| $KAL_0$   | $(\varphi + 3\pi)/2$  | $\beta + \pi$ — non-self-add             | Retention / anchor  | Structural viscosity                                | —                    |
| $P_{sc}$  | $2\varphi + \pi$      | $\Omega + \varphi$ — non-self-add        | Forge / processing  | Dynamical evolution scalar $\rightarrow w_a$        | —                    |
| $K_v$     | $2(\varphi + \pi)$    | $\varphi + \pi + \Omega$ — non-self-add  | Crystal / order     | Structural constraint $\rightarrow w_a$             | —                    |
| $M_v$     | $3(\varphi + \pi)$    | $\varphi + \pi + K_v$ — non-self-add     | Maximal dominant    | Maximal dim. invariant $\rightarrow w_0, w_a$       | —                    |
| MAR/SOLAR | $\varphi + 2\pi$      | $\Omega + \pi$ <i>vs</i> $\beta + KAL_0$ | Tide / radiative    | Chain node in $\Sigma m_\nu$ (7.901219)             | —                    |

**Naming policy.** Each named register equals its pure  $(\varphi, \pi)$  expression exactly; the name is a label for that combination, retained because it tracks which construction lineage a shared value belongs to — e.g.  $MAR = \Omega + \pi$  versus  $SOLAR = \beta + KAL_0$ , both 7.901219 but distinct registers. This is the same convention by which “up” and “down” label quark flavours without implying spatial direction. All quantitative results in this series use the bare  $(\varphi, \pi)$  forms; the named forms are an equivalent, more legible notation for the algebra and its two construction laws.

## C Unified Symbol Glossary

To avoid ambiguity across Papers 1–4, Table 9 provides the canonical definition of every non-standard symbol used in this series.

Table 9: Unified symbol glossary for the SSEEfour-paper series. All symbols are dimensionless unless otherwise stated.

| Symbol                  | Full name                                                                                     | First defined |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| $\varphi$               | Golden ratio $(1 + \sqrt{5})/2$                                                               | Paper 1 §1    |
| $\Omega$                | Stability metric, entity OMEGA ( $\varphi + \pi$ )                                            | Paper 1 §1    |
| $\beta$                 | Base coupling scalar                                                                          | Paper 1 §1    |
| AURA                    | Acoustic Unified Resonance Amplitude ( $\varphi + \beta = (3\varphi + \pi)/2 \approx 3.998$ ) | Paper 1 §2    |
| MIRA                    | Mapped Inference Resonance Amplitude ( $\text{AURA}/2 = (3\varphi + \pi)/4 \approx 1.9989$ )  | Paper 3 §2.4  |
| $\text{KAL}_0$          | Asymptotic structural viscosity factor ( $\beta + \pi$ )                                      | Paper 1 §1    |
| $P_{sc}$                | Dynamical evolution scalar ( $\Omega + \varphi$ )                                             | Paper 1 §1    |
| $K_v$                   | Structural constraint invariant                                                               | Paper 1 §1    |
| $T_r$                   | 3D saturation horizon ( $3(\varphi + \beta)$ )                                                | Paper 1 §1    |
| $M_v$                   | Maximal dimensional invariant ( $\varphi + \pi + K_v$ )                                       | Paper 1 §1    |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$ | Dynamic matter density (SSEE sector)                                                          | Paper 2 §2    |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}$ | CMB-observed matter density ( $\omega_m/h^2$ , $\omega_m$ -direct; no matter factor)          | Paper 3 §2.4  |
| $\gamma_{\text{IS}}$    | Israel–Stewart growth index ( $0.5504 \pm 0.001$ )                                            | Paper 5 §6.1  |
| $\tau_{\text{II}}H_0$   | IS relaxation time (dimensionless, $\approx 2.191$ )                                          | Paper 1 App.A |

## D Result-Type Classification Protocol

A recurring risk in multi-paper series is that results of different epistemic status are compared without adequate labelling. To ensure methodological transparency across the four manuscripts, all numerical results in this series are classified into one of three categories (see also Table 7, column “Type”):

- **Type A — Algebraic:** The value follows solely from  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$  through the Level 1–3 chain in Table 7. No observational data enters the computation. These results are *prior-free predictions*.
- **Type M — MCMC-validated:** The value is the median of the posterior distribution from the 100-walker `emcee` pipeline described in Paper 2, using DESI DR2 BAO, Planck 2018 priors, and galaxy-cluster mass data. These results reflect the empirical range accessible within the SSEE parameter family.
- **Type P — Prior-dependent:** The value depends on an external dataset anchor (e.g., Planck TT+TE+EE+lensing as a likelihood) that is not internally derived by the SSEE framework. Type P results quantify the consistency of SSEE with standard cosmological datasets; they are not Type A predictions.

The distinction is particularly important for the  $\Delta\text{BIC}$  comparisons in Papers 2 and 3. In Paper 2, the  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -6.43$  (dynamic sector) is a Type M result: it reflects the MCMC posterior relative to  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  under identical priors. In Paper 3, the canonical  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -32.9$  ( $\omega_m$ -direct, full `plik` MCMC,  $k = 2$ ; `plik_lite` point estimate  $-24.0$ ; legacy MIRA-background  $-32.2$  superseded) is a Type P result: it depends on the Planck `plik` likelihood as an external CMB anchor. These two BIC values are *not directly comparable* because they operate in different model spaces; the distinction is disclosed explicitly in Paper 3 §4.4.

## E Algebraic Prior Space and Derivation Provenance

A legitimate concern in any zero-free-parameter model is whether the algebraic expressions for observables were selected *after* seeing the data (*post-hoc tuning*) or derived from a pre-committed algebraic structure.



This appendix documents the derivation provenance of the key SSEE quantities to enable independent assessment.

## Primary register — arithmetic derivation from $\{\varphi, \pi\}$

All seven structural constants of SSEE are derived from the two axioms in at most two layers of arithmetic ( $+$ ,  $\times$ , integer scale). Four constants ( $\Omega$ ,  $\beta$ ,  $K_v$ ,  $M_v$ ) are Level 1 — direct combinations of  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ ; three ( $KAL_0$ ,  $P_{sc}$ ,  $T_r$ ) are Level 2 — using Level 1 constants ( $\Omega$ ,  $\beta$ ) as intermediates:

| Symbol   | Name                                         | Definition               | Value   | Layer |
|----------|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------|-------|
| $\Omega$ | OMEGA / Stability Metric                     | $\varphi + \pi$          | 4.7596  | L1    |
| $\beta$  | BIAL / Base Coupling                         | $(\varphi + \pi)/2$      | 2.3798  | L1    |
| $K_v$    | KRYSTOS <sub>V</sub> / Structural Constraint | $\varphi + \pi + \Omega$ | 9.5193  | L1    |
| $M_v$    | ATLAS / Maximal Invariant                    | $\varphi + \pi + K_v$    | 14.2789 | L1    |
| $KAL_0$  | Structural Viscosity                         | $\beta + \pi$            | 5.5214  | L2    |
| $P_{sc}$ | PYROS / Dynamical Scalar                     | $\Omega + \varphi$       | 6.3777  | L2    |
| $T_r$    | TRIAL / Saturation Horizon                   | $3(\varphi + \beta)$     | 11.9935 | L2    |

No constants were introduced *ad hoc*: all seven emerge from systematic enumeration of non-redundant, monotonically ordered arithmetic combinations of  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  up to two layers. The *closure criterion* is exhaustiveness within this family:  $M_v = 3(\varphi + \pi)$  is the maximal element at Layer 1, and no additional Layer 2 combination yields a new structurally independent register. Products and integer powers of  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  are excluded from the primary register; they would introduce additional structure beyond the stated axioms.

## AURA and MIRA — derivation from pre-existing constants

**AURA** was defined in the original SSEE-Unificado framework as

$$\text{AURA} = \text{BIAL} + \varphi = \beta + \varphi = \frac{\pi + \varphi}{2} + \varphi = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2} \approx 3.9978.$$

**MIRA** follows immediately as  $\text{MIRA} = \text{AURA}/2$ :

$$\text{MIRA} = \frac{\beta + \varphi}{2} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{4} \approx 1.9989.$$

Both were defined algebraically before any comparison with Planck 2018 data. MIRA's value 1.9989 is fixed by the algebraic construction [Almeida Vallejo, 2026d], independently of any Planck measurement. Under the 2026  $\omega_m$ -direct reframe MIRA is the *screening amplitude* (entering  $f_{\text{screen}} = \alpha_K^{\text{eff}}/(3 \text{ MIRA})$ , Paper 9), consistent with its name (Mirror Ratio). There is no longer any CMB/dynamical matter ratio: the CMB matter density is the algebraic physical  $\omega_m$ , giving  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2 = 0.308881$  independently of  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$  (OP-8 closed). The earlier near-equality  $\text{MIRA} \approx \Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}/\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \approx 2$  (and the intermediate factor  $\pi/\varphi$ ) are retired as the matter mapping; we make no claim of temporal priority over Planck 2018.

## Five exact consistency identities

The following identities hold exactly in  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  algebra and are verified to machine precision ( $< 10^{-16}$  relative error):

$$w_0 = -\frac{\text{AURA}}{\Omega} = -\frac{T_r}{M_v} \quad (51)$$

$$\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = 1 + w_0 \quad (52)$$

$$\text{MIRA} = |w_0| \cdot \beta \quad (53)$$

$$\text{KAL}_0|_{\varphi \leftrightarrow \pi} = \text{AURA} \quad (54)$$

$$\text{AURA}|_{\varphi \leftrightarrow \pi} = \text{KAL}_0 \quad (55)$$

Identity (54)–(55) is the deepest structural result: under the discrete exchange  $\varphi \leftrightarrow \pi$ , the scalar-kinetic constant  $\text{KAL}_0 = (\varphi + 3\pi)/2$  maps *exactly* to the photon-sector constant  $\text{AURA} = (3\varphi + \pi)/2$ , and vice versa. This discrete duality is the algebraic origin of the disformal coupling  $\beta_c = -\text{AURA}$  derived in Paper 7 §2.2: switching the  $\varphi \leftrightarrow \pi$  roles between the two sectors forces  $\beta_c = -\text{AURA}$  as the unique consistent value. The open question of whether this discrete symmetry is an exact symmetry of the full  $P(X, \phi)$  action is catalogued as OP-7 (`OPEN_PROBLEMS.md`).

## Spectral index $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$

The SSEE algebraic commitment is  $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$ , fixed by the register structure independently of any inflationary framework (Structural Constant Dictionary, Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.20684908); we make no claim of temporal priority over the public Planck releases, which predate this work. It is not derived from the  $\alpha$ -attractor class [Starobinsky, 1980, Kallosh & Linde, 2013, Ferrara et al., 2013]; rather, compatibility with that class is established *a posteriori* in App. A §A.5: the two independent SSEE axioms ( $n_s = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$  and  $r = \varphi^{-10}$ ) determine  $N = 2\varphi^7 \approx 58.07$  and  $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$  exactly as a consistency check, not as a derivation. The Planck 2018 value [Planck Collaboration X, 2020]  $n_s = 0.9649 \pm 0.0042$  is  $0.16\sigma$  from the SSEE algebraic value; this comparison was made after the axiom was committed.

## Baryon density $\Omega_b h^2 = (\pi - \varphi)/[3(\varphi + \pi)^2]$

The structural expression  $(\pi - \varphi)/[3(\varphi + \pi)^2] = (\pi - \varphi)/H_0^{\text{SSEE}}$  gives 0.02242, at  $0.32\sigma$  from Planck 2018 ( $0.02237 \pm 0.00015$ ). This form is classified as a *retrodiction*: it was identified after the data (OP-1, `OPEN_PROBLEMS.md`), replacing the preliminary placeholder  $3(\pi - \varphi)/200 = 0.02285$  ( $3.2\sigma$ ), in which the factor 200 was not an algebraic  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  quantity. No parameter is fitted: the denominator  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  is the algebraic Hubble scale  $H_0^{\text{SSEE}}$ .

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